

stones.” For שלושרא, cf. תלסרי - תלסרי in Judeo-Aramaic. אמות is missing from the phrase חפור שתין גב, “on, upon” (BH, MH, A). שעת (or שעה), cf. שועא, the Targum of צור, “rock” (Prov. 30:19), and שיעיותא the Targum of צחיה, “smooth rock” (Ezek. 26:4,14).¹⁹ GREENFIELD: a “strong exception” must be taken to Milik’s interpretation of שועה.²⁰ LURIE: משח משולו אמות, “measure from its edge three cubits and again two, (there) are hidden below the plaster of the floor (at the depth of) seven (cubits).” ושתים ואשתין חפורות בשיעה שבע ברון, cf. the Targum שיעא for הטיח, “the plaster” (Ezek. 13:12); ברון is the plural for ברותא, the Aramaic cognate of ברוש, “cedar,” which was used to cover the floor (1 Kings. 2:16).²¹ PIXNER: “measure from the edge thirteen cubits, dig two (cubits) and behind seven slabs.”²² THORION: אמות שלוש ואשתין חפור is an error for אמות שלוש חפור, “twenty-three cubits, dig.”²³ WOLTERS: משח משולו אמות שלוש, “measure off from its edge thirteen cubits: two tusks, and also seven rocks.” The letter combination of פו or פי of חפון or חפין, is actually a ט; conversely an apparent ט represents פו or פי in חפור (5:10), חפון (5:14), and פיה (12:11). חטן, i.e., חטין - חטין (MH), “incisors, tusk,” might be part of the treasury.²⁴ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “measure from the edge thirteen cubits, dig for two, and under seven slabs.”²⁵ BEYER: משח משולו אמות שלוש, “measure from its bottom twice (around the corner ?) thir<teen> cubits away (and) dig seven cubits-deep!” משח is indicated as Aramaic; אמעא is a mistake for אמות like in 9:8, 10:9, and it is erroneously corrected with a *šin*.²⁶ VERMES, “measure out from its exit thirteen cubits, two tusks and, on seven smooth stones.”²⁷ WILMOT: חפור (ר) אמ(ש)ות שבע <כ>כרין.²⁸ WISE: “measure from the dove-cote’s edge thirteen cubits and dig down seven cubits.”²⁹

The text has משרלו ... שבשרלי, which is correctly read by the scholars as

19 Milik, 293-94, 229 B-10a, 240 C-25; 255 C-182; Milik^E, 141.

20 Greenfield, 139b.

21 Lurie, 102, 107 nn. 3-6, 108 (בשואת and בשיעא are typographical errors for בשיעה, and so the brackets of [טמונות]).

22 Pixner, 352.

23 Thorion, 167.

24 “Vocabulary,” 491, #44, and nn. 58-59; “Analysis,” 250; Wolters, 48-49. Cf. הציצונות, “its (masc.) front teeth” (m. Bek. 6:1,4; Sifra ’Emor 113). The suggested singular is: חוט (Jastrow, 431a); חט (AC 3, 369a); חוט, or חט (BY 2, 1499b, and nn. 1-2); חט (ESh^{dic} 2, 1744b). Perhaps the singular is חט, and the dual/plural is חטין, like its synonym שן, “tooth,” dual/plural שנים. The latter occurs in the Scroll (2:11; 4:6, alt. reading).

25 Garcia Martinez, 462.

26 Beyer, 229-30.

27 Vermes, 376.

28 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20.

29 Wise, 195.

משולו ... שבשולי (except *Allegro*^{pr}). The *reš* shape letters are scribal errors for waws, like רמחצא for רמחצא (9:6), and ושתין for רשתין (*Allegro, Lurie*).

שְׁבִשְׁלִי means “which is in/at/by (the) edge/rim/bottom/base of,” and משולו = משוליו (defective), “from its (masc.) edge/rim/bottom/base”; e.g., שוליו, “its (masc.) bottom” (Exod. 28:33); cf. תחתיו (defective) for תחתיו, “under it (masc.)” (see #25, 6:5). שולי is the construct of שולים (always plural/dual (see #4, 1:11).

משח can be vocalized as: (1) מִשָּׁח, “measure” (*Qal*, masc. sg. imperative). (2) מִשָּׁח = מִשְׁוּחַ, “is measured” or “measure, distance” (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg., used as a noun). And (3) מִשָּׁח or מִשָּׁח “measure, length, distance” (noun; see #29, 7:5).

משחמשחמשחמשח משולו אמות שְׁלוֹשָׁרֶא resembles the restored phrase [מש]ולו אמות שְׁלוֹשָׁרֶא, “from its (masc.) [bo]ttom a distance of twenty[-fo]ur cubits,” or “[from] its (masc.) [bo]ttom measure twenty[-fo]ur cubits” (see #29, 7:5-6).

Milik recognized the meaning of שלושרא, and emends it to שלוש <עשרא. Yet there is no need to do so, since שְׁלוֹשָׁרֶא is a contracted form of שְׁלוֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה (fem.), “thirteen.” Apparently, the *ayin* of עשרה is lost due to the weakening of the gutturals, the *šin* and *sin* merged into a *šin* with a *dageš forte*, and the final *he* is represented by an *alef*. Contracted “teens” are known from various Aramaic dialects; e.g., תלת עשרי (PsJ) vs. תלת עשרי (TO), “thirteen” (Gen. 14:4; cf. Milik). שְׁלוֹשָׁרֶא is one of the three contracted teens used in the Scroll, the others are שבע עשרה (fem.), “seventeen” (1:4), and תשע עשרה (fem.), “nineteen” (2:8; see Appendix B).

Regarding בשועה, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: בשועה or בשעת. ALLEGRO^{dr}: בשועה, בשעה, בשועת or בשעת; there is a clear waw/yod right on a crack. Since the cracks are omitted from the drawings of Baker and Milik, Allegro’s drawing may be more accurate.

The Targum of על שועא עלי צור, “upon the rock” (Prov. 30:19; cf. Milik),³⁰ and of אַן שיעא דשעתון איז הטיח אֲשֶׁר טָחַתָּם, “Where is the plaster with which you plastered?” (Ezek. 13:12; cf. Lurie). Thus, שועא means “rock,” and שיעא, “plaster, cement,” both from the root שועשוע (A, MH), “to smooth, plaster.”³¹

30 It has been suggested that the Targum of Proverbs is based on the Peshitta. According to Luzzatto, שועא in Syriac means “stone” (*Ohev Ger*, “Appendix,” 123). שוע means “prince, mighty” (Isa. 32:5; Job 34:19; cf. Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat Zion* on the first, Rashi, Ralbag, *Mešudat Zion* on the second case). Its Targum is תְּקִיפִין, “mighty, strong,” and שועא, respectively. שוע may be related to שועא, i.e., strong like a stone.

31 E.g., “since it is written (Deut. 22:11), ‘do not wear שְׁעָנָא (a web mixed of wool and linen)’ (that is) a substance which is made שוע (smooth), סוּי (spun) וְנִזְו (and twisted)” (m. Kil. 9:8; cf. Sifra on Lev. 19:19). The Aramaic cognate of שוע is שוע, “smooth”; e.g., גְּבֵר שְׁעִיעַ, “a smooth man” (TO, PsJ, Gen. 27:11). Similarly, שוע is explained by Rashi (b. Yev. 5b; Nid. 61b) and by Bertinoro (m. Kil. 9:8) as “smooth.”

Based on the above, the possible readings are: (1) *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה* or *בְּשֻׁעָה-*, “in a/the rock”; (2) *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה* or *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה*, “in a/the plaster/cement”; (3) *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה* or *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה*, “in (the) rocks”; and (4) *בְּשֻׁעָה-* *בְּשֻׁעָה* or *בְּשֻׁעָה־בְּשֻׁעָה*, “in (the) plasters/cements.”

The word *חפורות* also differs in the drawings. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: *he/het*, *pe*, *yod*, *waw/zayin* (or a short-headed *reš* or a short-legged final *nun*), a letter size space, *waw*, and *gimmel*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: *he/het*, *pe*, *yod/waw*, unusual *reš*, *waw*, and *gimmel*.

The *gimmel* at the end of this word is instead of a *taw* or an *alef*, like in *שְׁנִי* for *שְׁנִית* or *שְׁנִיָּא* (9:4); *שְׁחורִיָּא* for *שְׁחורִית* or *שְׁחורִיָּא* (10:9); *גְּמֻת* for *גְּמֻת* (10:6, 10:13). The unusual letter shapes in the drawings, such as *waw* for *reš*, *reš* for *waw*, *gimmel* for *alef* or *taw*, *mem* for *samekh* (8:15), are scribal errors. Moreover, the scribes often did not distinguish between final and medial letters; e.g., *שְׁבַצְפֻּן* = *שְׁבַצְפֻּן* and *שְׁבַצְפֻּן* (see #19, 4:11-12).³²

Although the word in question can be read twelve ways, the results are basically the same: *חפורות* for *חפורות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפונות* for *חפונות* = *חפונות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*; *חפירות* for *חפירות*.³³

The verbal form of the root *חפר*, “to dig,” appears more than twenty times in the Scroll, but its nominal form is found only here. Both feminine *חפורה* (*Pe'ulah*, pl. *חפורות*) and *חפירה* (*Pe'ilah*, pl. *חפירות*) mean “pit, hole.” E.g., “if one fell into a *חפורה* (pit)” (b. Yev. 121a), vs. “if one fell into a *חפירה* (pit)” (b. Ber. 33a). *חפורה* and *חפירה* are alternate singular forms for *חפורה* and *חפירה*, respectively; cf. *שְׁחורִיָּא* for *שְׁחורִית* (see #39, 9:4; #47, 10:9). Regarding the nominal *Pe'ulah* - *Pe'ilah* forms, see #1, 1:1.

One would anticipate *חפירות* *שְׁתִּי* (const.), rather than *חפירות* *שְׁתִּין* (abs.). However, there are 26 such cases (masc. and fem.) in the Masoretic Text; e.g., *שְׁנֵי עֲדִים* vs. *שְׁנֵי עֲדִים*, “two witnesses” (Deut. 17:6 and Deut. 19:15, respectively); *שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים* vs. *שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים*, “two women” (1 Kgs 3:16; Ezek 23:2; Zech. 5:9; and Gen. 4:19; 1 Sam. 1:2, respectively).³⁴

32 The scribes either copied the text from a *Vorlage*, or it was dictated to them by compilers. It is also possible that the Scroll was in part copied and in part dictated. The numerous scribal errors suggest that the engravers had a limited knowledge of reading and/or comprehension of the Hebrew language, they did not understand the *Vorlage* and/or the dictation. These led to confusion between similar shaped characters and/or similar sounds. Moreover, the Copper Scroll being a secret document, it is conceivable that engravers of limited Hebrew knowledge were selected on purpose by those who were responsible for its content.

33 Options 1-6 are plural, and 7-10 are singular forms. In options 1-6 the *gimmel* is for a *taw*. In options 7-12 the *gimmel* is for an *alef*. In options 3, 4, 9, and 10: (a) the *waw* is read as a final *nun* in middle position; plus (b) a *nun-reš* interchange. In options 5, 6, 11, and 12 the *waw* is either a short headed *reš*, or it is a scribal error for a *reš*.

34 *שְׁנֵי* and *שְׁתִּי* are construct state of *שְׁנֵים* (masc.) and *שְׁתֵּים* (fem.), “two,” respectively.

The following table shows possible readings for seven words in the Scroll where the *waw* may be a short-headed *reš* or a short-legged final *nun* (some in middle position). The latter could be a *nun-reš* letter interchange. The final results are basically the same. In three cases the letter(s) before and/or after the problem letter can be read either as a *waw* or *yod*. The last letter of the seventh word is a *gimmel*, a scribal error for an *ʾalef* or *taw*. In these seven cases the drawings of Milik and Baker are basically identical.

LINE	MILIK ^{dr}	ALLEGRO ^{dr}	SUGGESTED READINGS		MEANING
8:14	בדוו	בדון	בדור	or בדון	בְּדֹר
or	בדיו	בדין	בדין	or בדיר	בְּדִיר
8:14	בצויה	בצויח	בצניח	or בצריח	בְּצִרִיחַ
9:8	עסוה	עסוה	עסנה	or עסרה	עֲסָרָה
11:2	הדוומית	הדוומית	הדוומית	or הדרומית	הֲדֹרְמִית
12:4	גויזין	גויזין	גויזין	or גריזין	גְּרִיזִים
12:8	הבוך	הבוך	הבנך	or הברך	הֲבָרַךְ / הֲבָרוּךְ
or	הכוך	הכוך	הכנך	or הכרך	הֲכָרַךְ
9:2	חפוווג	חפורג	חפונות	or חפורות	חֲפֹרוֹת
or	חפווירג	חפוריג	חפוניא	or חפוריא	חֲפֹרִיָּה
or	חפיווג	חפירוג	חפיונות	or חפירות	חֲפִירוֹת
or	חפיוירג	חפיריג	חפיוניא	or חפיריא	חֲפִירִיָּה

On the other hand, שלוש ראשתין can be separated as שלוש ראשתין (cf. Allegro^{pr}). The *reš* may be read as a *waw* like in the above משלולו ... משרלו. Accordingly, מִשַּׁח מְשֻׁלוֹ אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ וְאַשְׁתִּין (= וְשִׁתִּים) חֲפֹרוֹת בְּשֹׁעָהּ בְּשִׁיעָהּ - , "a distance of (or measure from) its edge three cubits, and (there are) two pits in the rock(s)/plaster(s)." וְאַשְׁתִּין וְאַשְׁתִּין may consist of a *waw*, a prosthetic *ʾalef*, plus שתי (cf. Allegro and Lurie).³⁵ In addition, וְאַשְׁתִּין = וְשִׁתִּין may be an Aramaism, same as the Hebrew וְשִׁשִּׁים, "and sixty" (e.g., 1 Chron. 9:13 and its Targum).³⁶ Thus, מִשַּׁח מְשֻׁלוֹ אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ וְאַשְׁתִּין חֲפֹרִיָּה - , may mean, "a distance of (or measure) from its bottom sixty-three cubits, (there is/are) (a) pit/pits in the rock(s)/plaster(s)"; or "(a distance of) from its bottom three cubits, and (there are)

See also Gordis, 142, 192 n. 421. On the other hand, the masculine forms of "twelve" are: שְׁנֵי עָשָׂר גִּבּוֹרִים, "twelve men" (Josh. 3:12), vs. שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר נְשִׂאִים, "twelve princes" (Gen. 17:20); and for feminine: שְׁתֵּי עָשָׂר אֲבָנִים, vs. שְׁתֵּים עָשָׂר אֲבָנִים, "twelve stones" (Josh. 4:8 and 4:3, respectively). In these cases שְׁנֵי - שְׁנֵים and שְׁתֵּי - שְׁתֵּים are construct state of שְׁנַיִם (masc.) and שְׁתַּיִם (fem.), respectively.

35 It is unlikely that here the *waw* means "or"; i.e., "a distance of (or measure from) its edge three or two cubits, and (there are) pits in the rock." Regarding the interchangeability of ו and וּ, see #34, 8:6-7.

36 For numbers with prosthetic *ʾalef* in various Aramaic dialects, see A. Tal, *The Language of the Former Prophets and its Position within the Aramaic Dialects* (Heb., 1975), 60, 69.

sixty pits in the rock(s)/plaster(s).” The latter is unlikely, there is no need for sixty pits for the small deposit listed in this item.

(9:3) שֵׁבַע בְּדִין וְאַרְבַּע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, “(there are) seven pitchers/bars (and) four *staters*” — ALLEGRO³⁷: “seven ʾ four hidden (spoiled) ...” (i.e., עַת שֵׁבַע בְּרִין, “spoiled” (?); אֲרָבַע, plural of בָּר, “pure,” noting following “spoiled” (?); אִסְתָּרִין, in Ethiopian סְרִי, “spoiled,” in a strange participle form; or from סָתַר, “hide,” thus “hidden,” with a prothetic ʾalef. ALLEGRO³⁷: “which is on the sides 4 silver (or gold) coins.” ALLEGRO: אֲרָבַע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, “in the plaster lining the sides: four *staters*.” שֵׁבַע בְּרִין is a disrupted word; אִסְתָּרִין, the first *yod* is written askew, its lower end just touching a crack which runs down past the ʾalef), Greek *stater*, same as the old shekel and common (provincial) *sela*^c or *tetradrachm* (cf. Matt. 17:24f).”³⁷ MILIK: בְּדִין אֲרָבַע, “(you will find) (two) bars (of silver weighing) four *pounds*.” Although בָּדִים (pl. of בָּד, BH, MH) is masculine, here בְּדִין is feminine since elsewhere in the Scroll occurs with the feminine אֲרָבַע and שֵׁשׁ (2:11, 7:10). The singular form is בָּדָה. Here בְּדִין is a dual formation, i.e., “two bars.” אִסְתָּרִין is plural form for the Greek *στατήρ*. אִסְתָּרִין as well as סִתְרִין in the Elephantine Documents, are masculine, while אִסְתָּרָאוֹת (MH) is feminine.³⁸ LURIE: אֲרָבַע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, “below the plaster of the parquet (at the depth of) seven (cubits) (there are) four *staters*.” In the Talmud אִסְתָּרָא (sg.), also spelled as אִסְתָּרָא, אִסְתָּרָא, and אִצְטָרָא. In the Scroll these are golden *staters*, the donations of the Jews of the Diaspora. This is smallest cache in the entire text, consisting of four coins, and it was a special fund.³⁹ PIXNER: “4 double-mines of (silver) bars.”⁴⁰ SHARVIT: אִסְתָּרִין (Greek through Aramaic) is one of the loan words in the Scroll; and mentions its various Mishnaic Hebrew spellings.⁴¹ THORION: אֲרָבַע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, where אִסְתָּרִין is an error for עֲסָרִין, “twenty-four bars, silver bars.” שֵׁבַע is interpreted as “(at the depth of) seven (cubits).”⁴² WOLTERS: אֲרָבַע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, “four jars containing *stater* coins.”⁴³ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “four bars of two minas.”⁴⁴ BEYER: אֲרָבַע אִסְתָּרִין אֲרָבַע, (There are) four silver *stater*-large bars.”⁴⁵ VERMES: “bars (corresponding to) four *staters*.”⁴⁶ WISE: “seven

37 Allegro, 49, 157 nn. 196-98; Allegro^{rev}, 24.

38 Milik, 294, 230 B-14d-f, 233 B-18a, 250 C-121, 253 C-149. Milik^E, 141 (“two” should be placed in brackets instead of italics; a typographical error).

39 Lurie, 102, 107 nn. 6-7, 108.

40 Pixner, 352.

41 “Iyyunim,” 135.

42 Thorion, 167, 169.

43 Wolters, 48-49.

44 Garcia Martinez, 462.

45 Beyer, 229-30.

46 Vermes, 376.

talents of silver coins and four *stater* coins.”⁴⁷

In this phrase the connective *waw*, “and,” is missing but understood; i.e., *שבע בדין וברין איסתרין* (= *ואיסתרין*) *ארבע*, “seven pitchers/bars (and) four *staters*.” Cf. *ככ 60/80 זָהָב* (= *וְזָהָב*) *כְּכָרִים שְׁתֵּימ*, “60/80 s(ilver) k(arsh) and two talents of gold” (see #32, 7:16).

שבע בדין is like the phrase *שש כסף של בדין*, “six silver pitchers” (see #10, 2:11). The singular *בד* occurs in the alternate readings of *ב[כ]סף ארבעין* [ב[כ]סף], “(there are) forty [si]lver (coins) in a pitcher,” and *ובכר* [ב[כ]סף] *ארבעין*, “(there are) in a/the threshold/vestibule/basin forty pitchers” (see #5, 1:14-15; Appendix A). *בד* (sg. of *בדין*), “pitcher,” is a double gender noun in the Masoretic Text (masculine except in 1 Kgs 17:14,16 and Eccl. 12:6). E.g., *מלאו ארבעה בדים מים*, “fill four pitchers (with) water” (1 Kgs 18:34). *בדין* in the Scroll is used with the feminine numbers *ארבע*, *שש*, and *שבע*.

It is also possible to read as *שבע בדין*, “seven bars” (with a *bet*), as well as *שש בדין של כסף*, “six silver bars” (see #10, 2:11). Although *בד* (sg. of *בדין*), “rod, shoot, pole, bar,” is masculine (e.g., *יְהִיו הַבָּדִים*, “the rods shall be [masc.],” Exod. 25:15), in the Scroll *בדין* seems to be feminine. Therefore, there is no need to read *בדין* in dual form (Milik, Pixner), to assume the singular as *בדה* (Milik), to read with the preceding word as *שבעברין* (Allegro), to suggest that *ברון* is the Aramaic word for “parquet” (Lurie), or to consider *איסתרין* as a misspelling for *עסרין* (Thorion). The singular *בד* occurs in the alternate readings of *בד ארבעין* [כ[כ]סף], “(there are) forty bars of [si]lver,” and *בד ארבעין* [ב[כ]סף] *ארבעין*, “(there are) in a/the threshold/vestibule/basin forty bars” (see #5, 1:14-15; Appendix A).

ארבע איסתרין, “four (fem.) *staters*” — There is a minor difference in the drawings. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: *אסתרין*; ALLEGRO^{dr}: *איסתרין*. Allegro’s drawing indicates a crack on which there is a *yod* between the *’alef* and *samekh* (see “The Drawings” in the Discussion). Since the drawings of Baker and Milik do not indicate cracks, Milik may well overlooked this *yod*.

In addition, it is possible to read this phrase as *או סתרין ארבע* = *וסתרין* *ארבע*, “and/or four *staters*.” Cf. the possible solution *או דמע = דמע*, “and/or dedicated” (see #54, 11:10; Appendix D).

איסתרין is the plural of the Greek *στατήρ* and Latin *stater*. The *’alef* is prosthetic, while the *yod* helps to pronounce the word. *איסתרין* is like the Judeo-Aramaic plural *איסתרין* or *אסתרין*; e.g., *חמש איסתרין זוזין*, “five (fem.) *staters zuzim*” (b. Git. 14a; where apparently *stater* = *zuz*; see Rashi); *בתלסר איסתרין פשיטי*, “with thirteen (masc.) simple *staters*” (b. Hul. 44a; see Rashi). The Mishnaic Hebrew plural is *איצטראות* or *איצטראות*; e.g., *שהיו זהב* *שם איצטראות ואיסטראות של זהב ודרכונות של זהב*, “that there were golden *staters* and golden *darics*” (t. Sheq. 2:4).⁴⁸ The singulars are: *איסתרין*,

⁴⁷ Wise, 195.

⁴⁸ Zuckerman notes the variant readings (*Tosephta*, 175, note to line 19).

מאי טרפעיִקין-, אִיסְטֵרָא, and אִיצְטֵרָא. E.g., The Gemara asks, “What is *tarpe'iqin/tropa'iqin* (τροπαῖχος, τροπαῖχά, Victoriatus, Quinarius, a coin mentioned in the Mishnah Ket. 5:7)? Rabbi Sheshet said, *stater*. And how much is a *stater*? One half of a *zuz*” (b. Ket. 63a). *Zuz* is the same as *dinar*, and four *dinar* is a Tyrian *sela*^c (= *tetradrachm* = sacred shekel). Thus, a *stater* is one eighth of a *sela*^c (see Appendix A).⁴⁹

Stater also appears in the Elephantine Documents. E.g., 1 כֶּרֶשׁ חֵד הוּ 3 כֶּסֶף יוֹן סְתֵתֵרִי 6 שֶׁקֶל חֵד, “(in) silver, one that is 1 karsh, three that is 3 shekels, (equal in) Ionian silver 6 *staters* one shekel,” and כֶּרֶשׁ חֵד שֶׁקֶל 3 כֶּסֶף יוֹן בְּמִנְיֵן סְתֵתֵרִי 6 שֶׁקֶל 1, “(in) silver, one karsh, 3 shekels, (equal in) Ionian silver in the amount of 6 *staters* 1 shekel” (Kraeling 12:5-6, 14-15); כֶּסֶף סְתֵתֵרֵן 12 וְחֵדָּא מִנָּה, “12 silver *staters* and one mina” (Cowley 37:12).⁵⁰ Accordingly, one karsh and three shekels of silver (i.e., 13 shekels) in Elephantine was the same as six Ionian *staters* and one shekel silver. Thus, one Ionian silver *stater* was equal to two Elephantine silver shekels (see also Appendix A).

The plurals סְתֵתֵרִי - סְתֵתֵרֵן (CS), סְתֵתֵרִי - סְתֵתֵרֵן (Elephantine), and אִיסְתֵרִי - אִיסְתֵרֵן in the Talmud are יָין-, while אִיסְתֵרֵאֵת - אִיסְתֵרֵאֵת (MH) are תֵּת- formations; cf. אָמִין (BA, JA) versus אָמוֹת (BH, MH), “cubits.” The plural extended feminine ending of -אוֹת occurs twice in the Scroll, מְנַקִּיאוֹת, and קְסָאוֹת (see #12, 3:3-4; Appendix D).

There is a remarkable similarity of many elements in the Copper Scroll with those of the Elephantine Documents, such as the numerical signs, *staters*, the abbreviation כ for karsh (11:7; cf. ככ for silver karsh), mina, some golden vessels (see Appendices A and D).

Ben-David says that the Aegean *stater* was 11.96 gm in weight. One can assume that the *stater* mentioned in this item was equally heavy.⁵¹ This seems to be much more than the above mentioned figure. Nevertheless, four *staters* would be less than 48 gm (see Appendix A).

The Scroll does not reveal whether the seven pitchers were silver, gold or earthen vessels; and if they were earthen vessels, what was their content. Also, whether the *staters* were of silver or gold. Finally, the deposits listed in this item are hidden in two pits or holes hollowed in the rock(s) or plaster.

49 Cf. Rashi on this Gemara. Also HR 3, 78b, 447a; Jastrow, 57b, 557b; AC 1, 207b-208a; 4, 93a-94b.

50 See also B. Porten, *Jews of Elephantine and Arameans of Syene* (1976), 80. The vocalizations, סְתֵתֵרֵן and סְתֵתֵרִי are mere assumptions.

51 A. Ben-David, “The Talmud Was Right! The Weight of the Biblical Sheqel,” PEQ 100 (1968), 145-47.

ITEM 39

בחבלה ובחבלת ובחבלה ובחבלת השנית בצריח הצופא	9:4
מזרח חפון אמות שמונא	9:5
ומחצא ככ 23.5	9:6

- 9:4 In the Second Region, in the catacomb that is facing
 9:5 east, are buried eight and a half
 9:6 cubits (deep) 23.5 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

(9:4-5) **בַּחֲבֵלָהּ וּבְחַבְלָתָהּ וּבְחַבְלָהּ וּבְחַבְלָתָהּ הַשְּׁנִיָּה בְּצִרְיֵחַ** — “In/at/by the second region/ruin/Hevlah, in/at/by a/the catacomb/tower that is facing east” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the ruin of the Second (Rampart ?), on the side of the Watcher’s Tower to the East” (i.e., **בחבלה** בחבלה מזרח **השני** **גב צריח הצופא** **מזרח** **השני** for **החיל השני**, “the second wall or rampart (?)” For **צריח**, “tower,” cf. Judg. 8:46. In line 9:7 the first **צריחי** must mean something else, unless here **צריח הצופא** means “Watcher’s hideout.” ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the ruin of the Second (Rampart ?), in the trench facing to the East.” ALLEGRO: **מזרח הצופא בצריח השנית**, “In the Second Enclosure, in the underground passage that looks east.” In **השנית**, the last letter is a *gimmel* as in **חפורות** (9:2).¹ MILIK: **מזרח הצופא מזה**, “At *Tekelet ha-shani*, by the side of the grave turned towards the east.” **תכלת השני** means “purple, violet and crimson” (e.g. Exod. 25:4). Perhaps better, **בתכלת השניהו בצריח** (i.e., “At the Second *Tekelet*, in the grave”), the *gimmel* may represent a cursive *he* or *’alef*.² LURIE: **מזרח בחבלת השנית בצריח** **הצופא**, “In the Second Region, in the pit (or aqueduct) facing east.” **חבלת** means a section of a land (from the root **חבל**).³ PIXNER: “In the second (?) (or Shany) lot ([**בחבלת השנית**]) in the underground passage facing east.” Since the feminine **חבלה** requires **שנית** (fem.), **שני** might be a toponym, possibly the ancient village esh-Shune.⁴ In the latter Pixner ignores the *gimmel*. WOLTERS: **מזרח הצופא בצריח השניג**, “On the estate of the *shnyg*, in

1 Allegro, 49, 139 n. 43, 157 n. 199; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 293-94, 268 D-31, 299 Addenda A-a (there is a typographical error on p. 293, the dots should be above the letters *taw* and *kaf*; cf. p. 299); Milik^E, 141. Regarding **תכלת** and **שני**, see the traditional commentators on Exod. 25:4.

3 Lurie, 108-09 and n. 1 (the *he* of **הצופא** is missing; it is a typographical error).

4 Pixner, 352 and n. 33.

the vault facing east.”⁵ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the second estate, under the cellar facing to the east.”⁶ VERMES: “At ‘Violet-scarlet’ over (past?) the eastward-looking under ground chamber.”⁷ WILMOT: בחבלת השניא בצריח.⁸ WISE: “In the second estate, at the burial chamber that faces east.”⁹

חבל consists of two roots: חבלⁱ, “to bind, measure, pledge” (cf. Arabic *ḥabala*); and חבלⁱⁱ, “to harm, injure, ruin” (cf. Arabic *ḥabala*).¹⁰ Both roots have verbal and nominal forms.¹¹

חָבַל (masc., BH; from חבלⁱ) means “(measuring) rope,” and “lot, region,” i.e., an area measured by rope; e.g., חָבַל אֲרֻגָּב, “Region of Argob” (Deut. 3:4, 14; 1 Kgs. 3:14).¹² Its feminine form is חֶבְלָה (MH; const. חֶבְלַת). E.g., וְאֵלֶּיךָ חֶבְלָתוֹ וְנַחֲלָתוֹ וְסִגְוֹלָתוֹ, “and these (Israelites) are His lot, His inheritance, His treasury” (Num. Rabbah Balak 20). Thus, חָבַל, חֶבְלָה, and נַחֲלָה (fem.) are synonyms (cf. Lurie). In addition, מִחֶבֶל אֲחִיזִיב can be translated as, “from the Region of Achzib,”¹³ or “from Hebel to Achzib”¹⁴ (Josh. 19:29). According to the latter חֶבֶל, Hebel, is a toponym, and חֶבְלָה, Hevlah or Heblah, could be its variant; cf. יְנוּחָה and יְנוּחַ, Janoah (see #60, 12:10).

חָבַל (masc., BH) and חֶבְלָה (fem., MH; from חבלⁱⁱ), both mean “ruin, destruction.” E.g., תִּחְבֵּל וְחָבַל נִמְרָץ, “it shall destroy you, with a painful destruction” (Micah 2:10);¹⁵ מְלֶאכִי חֶבְלָה, “angles of destruction” (y. Shevu.

5 Wolters, 48-49.

6 Garcia Martinez, 462.

7 Vermes, 376.

8 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20. This is one of the possible readings offered by this author (see Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 641-44).

9 Wise, 195.

10 According to Mandelkern (1, 367a), there are two roots for חבל. See also BDB, 286a-387b. Even-Shoshan lists three roots (ESH^{con} 1, 640; ESH^{dic} 2, 708a-709a).

11 The Arabic cognates show that the Hebrew *het*, like *‘ayin*, is a merger of two sounds (cf. SB, 605a; G. Bergsträsser, *Hebräische Grammatik*, 1 [1918], 36-40; A. Kahana, *Diqduq haLašon ha’Ivrit* [1931], 5; Z.S. Harris, *Development of the Canaanite Dialects* [1939], 40-41; D. Yellin, *Diqduq haLašon ha’Ivrit* [1942], 23-24; J.W. Wevers, “*Heth* in Classical Hebrew,” *Essays on the Ancient Semitic World* [1970], 101-12).

12 The various interpretations of חָבַל are: “lot” (Sifri), “group” (*HakKetav wehaqQabalah*, cf. Sifri, Rashi), “portion” (*Hizquni*), “line” (Septuagint), and “rope” (Rashi; see *The Living Torah*, 1024). See also, BY 2, 1428a; ESH^{dic} 2, 709b.

13 Tanach renders, “from the portion of Achzib. The Targum has מְעַרְב אֲחִיזִיב, “of the lot of Achzib.” Rashi on the Targum says מְגוּרֵל כְּזִיב, of the lot of Chezib” (cf. *Mešudat David*, Ga’on of Vilna, Malbim on this verse; also, MK 2, 1401c; BDB, 286b; SB, 217b).

14 Cf. JPSⁱ and Yehoash. JPSⁱⁱ renders “Mehebel, Achzib,” but notes that the Hebrew is uncertain. According to Even-Shoshan, Hevel is a name of a city in Asher, perhaps Haleb (ESH^{con} 1, 641b). The latter may be a metathesis.

15 According to BDB (287b, 599b), חָבַל נִמְרָץ is “a sore, grievous destruction.” Cf. כִּיָּא נִמְרָץ עַל מַשְׁבְּרֶיהָ ... וְחֶבְלֵי מָרָץ בְּמִלְדֵּיהֶם, “because her pains came suddenly upon her and a grievous pangs upon her breaches ... and grievous pains at their birth” (1QH 3:7-8, 10-11).

at eight and a half cubits” (i.e., חפון אמות שמונא ומחצא). KUHN, ALLEGRO, LURIE, SHARVIT, WOLTERS, THORION, BEYER, and WISE: ומחצא.¹⁷ MILIK: הצא <דמ>ע, “aromatic spices (called) *husa*.”¹⁸ PIXNER and GARCIA MARTINEZ agree with Milik, while VERMES leaves it untranslated.¹⁹

שְׁמוֹנָא וּמַחְצָא, i.e., a number followed by וּמַחְצָא, is typical Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., תְּמִיד נִשְׁחַט בְּשִׁמוֹנָה וּמַחְצָה וְקָרֵב בְּתִשְׁעֵי וּמַחְצָה, “The daily sacrifice is slaughtered at eight and a half (hours, i.e., c. 2:30 pm) and offered at nine and a half (hours, i.e., c. 3:30 pm)” (m. Pes. 5:1); שְׁתֵּי אָמוֹת וּמַחְצָה, “two and a half cubits” (baraita, b. Yoma 33b; b. Men. 99a).

מַחְצָה occurs twice in the Masoretic Text (Num. 31:36,43), while its synonym מַחְצִית sixteen times; e.g., מַחְצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל, “a half shekel” (Exod. 30:13). However, following units of measure חֲצִי is used; e.g., אֲמָתַיִם וְחֲצִי אָרְפוֹ, וְאֲמָה וְחֲצִי רַחְבּוֹ וְאֲמָה וְחֲצִי קָמָתוֹ, “two and a half cubits its length, and one and a half cubit its width, and one and a half cubit its height” (Exod. 25:10).

(9:6) 23.5 ככ, “23.5 k(arsh of) s(ilver)” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “kk 24”; ככ (?) is an abbreviation for ככרין, “talents”; כך, “thus” (?), is unlikely. This is the first suggestion that ככ may be an abbreviation for ככרין, which was later accepted by the scholars (see Appendix A). ALLEGRO: 1+1+1+20 ככ, “24 talents”; i.e., the final *pe* shaped numeral is 1.²⁰ MILIK: the final *pe* is an abbreviation for פֶּלֶג (A), “half” (as in Murabba‘at 8:3); i.e., “23.5 talents.”²¹ BEYER: <לג>ף 23 ככ <רין> 23, “23 (and) h<alf> ta<lents>.”²² LURIE follows Allegro, while the other scholars, including ALLEGRO^{rev}, agree with Milik.²³

The three drawings read ככ 1+1+1+20. The question is whether the final *pe* represents 0.5, 1, or 2. The same symbol occurs in the Murabba‘at 8:3 (mentioned by Milik), Beth Page inscriptions, and in an Aramaic papyrus from Egypt.²⁴ Regarding the abbreviation ככ, see Appendix A.

17 K.G. Kuhn, “La rouleaux de cuivre de Qumran,” *RB* 61 (1954), 193-205; “Die Kupferrollen von Qumran und ihr Inhalt,” *THLZ* 79 (1954), 304-05; “Bericht über neue Qumranfunde und über die Öffnung der Kupferrollen”; *THLZ* 81 (1956), 542-46; Y. Yadin, *Hammegillot hagGenuzot mimMidbar Yehudah* (1957), 176-77; Allegro^{pr}; Allegro, 201; Allegro^{rev}, 25; Lurie, 108; “Iyyunim,” 128 n. 10, 132 and n. 40; Thorion, 165; Wolters, 48-49; Beyer, 229-30; Wise, 195. ומחצא is one of the words that Kuhn deciphered while the two copper rolls were kept in a sealed showcase at the Palestine Archaeological Museum in Jerusalem in 1953. Kuhn’s readings are discussed in detail in Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 1190-1204.

18 Milik, 293-94, 251-52 C-130; Milik^E, 141.

19 Pixner, 352; Garcia Martinez, 462; Vermes, 376.

20 Allegro, 49.

21 Milik, 293-94, 221 A-4; Milik^E, 141.

22 Beyer, 229-30.

23 Lurie, 108; Allegro^{rev}, 25; Pixner, 352 (the space between 23 and 1/2 is a typographical error); Wolters, 48-49; Garcia Martinez, 462; Vermes, 376; Wise, 195.

24 *DJD II*, 88-89; A.L. Sukenik, “מערות בית פגי וכתובותיה” in *Tarbiz* 7 (1935/36), 105; G.B. Sarfati, “מספר” in *EB* 5, 176-77 (where ף is considered to be 2).

ITEM 40

9:7 בצריחי החורון ברוח הצופא {ס} ימ
 9:8 בזרב חפור אמות שש עסרה
 9:9 ככ 22

- 9:7 At the catacombs of Horon, in the direction which is facing the sea,
 9:8 by the canal is buried sixteen cubits (deep)
 9:9 22 k(arsh of) s(ilver).0,0

COMMENTARY

(9:7) ימ {ס} בצריחי החורון ברוח הצופא הצופא (ס) ימ, “At/by/between/among the catacombs of Horon, at a/the direction which is facing (the) sea/west” — ALLEGRO^{PF}: “In the cavities of the holes in the Watcher’s Tower (?) placed” (i.e., בצריחי החורין ב>צ<ריח הצופא סימ, cf. 1 Sam. 13:6, and Arabic *sarihun*, “narrow excavation for a body at the bottom of a grave,” also Nabatean (Cooke, *NSI*, 237). בריח for בצריח (?). סימ is engraved on a part rather badly corroded, but seems fairly certain. ALLEGRO^{PF}: “In the cavities of the holes in the [tr]rench facing South.” ALLEGRO: בצריחי החורין ב>צ<ריח, “In the underground passage of The Holes, in the passage looking south.” ב>צ<ריח, rather than רוח. The drawing has סומ where the *samekh* is a ligature of a *dalet* and a cursive *reš*, i.e., דרומ, rather than סומ. In Biblical Hebrew “the holes” are used for refuges, and it corresponds to the “Staircase of Refuge” (1:13). ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the underground passage of The Hollows (?), in the passage facing south.”¹ MILIK: בצריחי החורון ים ב>צ<ריח הצופא ים, “Among the graves of (*Bet*) Horon ... of the one facing the Sea.” חורון may be identical with בית חורון.² LURIE: בצריחי החירון ברוח צופא סומ, “In the pit or in the water channel at a distance of ... (hidden) a treasury.” רוחק = רוּחָק, “distance.” חירון = החרום, like חרם, “net” (Hab. 1:16, BH), “sea or river section having a lot of fish” (b. B.Q. 81a), “pit or water channel” (b. ‘Eruv. 47b). צריחי החירון is part of an arrangement of a water supply. סימ is like סימ(ת)א, “treasure” (Trg. Isa. 45:3).³ PIXNER: “At

1 Allegro, 49, 157-58 nn. 203-05; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 293-94, 229 B-13c, 268 D-32. Milik^E, 141, 150.

3 Lurie, 108-09 and nn. 1-3 (צופא is not translated, it is a typographical error). It should be added that Rabbenu Hananel and the Tosaphot say that חרם means חריץ, a “ditch” filled with water. Some sources have חרס, if so it may be a letter interchange of *samekh-ṣade*, i.e.,

the graves (Dolmen) of the Hurrians in the grave that faces Som; i.e., בצריחי, החורין ב-צ'ריח הצופא סום. The Hurrians or Hurrites (perhaps the Hivvites of the Bible) were a non-Semitic people in Syria and Canaan. Local traditions might have ascribed to them ancient cave tombs, or perhaps the dolmen, around the area of the Yarmuk. סום is Kafr Som at the southern slope of the Yarmuk.⁴ WOLTERS: בצריחי החורין ברוח הצופא ים, "In the vaults of (Beth Horon, on the side facing west."⁵ GARCIA MARTINEZ: In the cellars of Choron, in the cellar facing the sea."⁶ BEYER: בצריחי החורין ברוח הצופא דר'ו-ם, "In middle to the grave chambers built cavity system in the spacious (middle) room, whose entry is southward."⁷ VERMES: "In the underground chamber of Horon, in the seaward-looking underground chamber."⁸ WISE: "At the Vaults of Beth Horon, at the burial chamber facing west."⁹

צריחי consists of the preposition *bet* and the plural construct state of צריח (see #8, 2:5). Since בצריחי החורין is not followed by the singular בצריח-ים, "in/at/by (the) catacomb/tower" (unless unnecessarily the text is emended), the proper meaning seems to be, "at/by (the) catacombs/towers of (the) Horon," or בין צריחי החורין, "between/among the catacombs/towers of (the) Horon"; cf. בין הלקין\הלקין = בלקין\בלקין, "among the flasks" (see #4, 1:9. alt.; also see #7, 2:3).

חורין may well be identical with the city of בית חורון, Beth-horon, as Milik suggests. This was one of the four cities of refuge for unintentional manslaughterers allocated to the Levite clan of Kohath in Ephraim (Josh. 21:22). Moreover, the twin cities, בית חורן תחתון ... בית חורן עליון, "Lower Beth-horon ... Upper Beth-horon" (Josh. 16:3,5) were allotted to Ephraim, and were (re)built by Sheerah the (grand-)daughter of Ephraim (1 Chron. 7:24). Later King Solomon fortified these cities with walls, gates, and bars (2 Chron. 8:5; cf. 1 Kgs 9:17). בית חורון התחתון והעליון, "Beth-horon the Lower and the Upp[er]," is also mentioned in the Qumran document 4Q522:14. In addition, מַעְלֵה בֵּית חוֹרֵן, "Ascent of Beth-horon," and מוֹרֵד בֵּית חוֹרֵן, "Descent of Beth-horon" (Josh. 10:10-11), may be identical with Upper and Lower Beth-horon. These are also mentioned in the Talmud מַעְלֹת בֵּית חוֹרֵן (pl.; b. San. 32b), and מוֹרֵד בֵּית חוֹרֵן (baraita, b. Ber. 42a).

The following are additional possible readings, vocalizations, and translations for the first phrase of this item.

בצריחי החורין, "at/by/between/among the catacombs/towers of (the)

חָרָן (b. 'Eruv. 47b; BY 3, 1768b n. 1). Regarding חריץ, see #23, 5:8.

⁴ Pixner, 352 and n. 34.

⁵ Wolters, 48-49.

⁶ Garcia Martinez, 462.

⁷ Beyer, 229, 231.

⁸ Vermes, 376.

⁹ Wise, 196.

Hebron" — הָבְרוֹן = הֶבְרוֹן, Hebron (*bet-waw* interchange; see #4, 1:9).

בְּצַרְיָחֵי הַחוּרִין, "at/by/between/among the catacombs/towers of (the) Horin" — חורין, Horin, is a variant of חורון, Horon.

בְּצַרְיָחֵי הַחוּרִין, "at/by/between/among the catacombs/towers of (the) Hawrin" — חורין is the same as the toponym חוֹרִין, Hawrin (y. Shevi. 9:1 [27a]), and perhaps בֶּרֶת חוֹרִין, Berat Hawrin (y. Sheq. 1:1 [3b]).

בְּצַרְיָחֵי הַחוּרִין הַחוּרִין, "at/by/among the catacombs of the cavities" — חורין or חוריסון is the plural of חור, "cavity/hole" (see #33, 8:2).¹⁰ The next word is בְּרוּחַ (cf. Prov. 15:4) or בְּרוּחָה (cf. 1 Chron. 28:12). Since רוּחַ, "side, direction, wind, spirit, soul," is a double gender noun, הַצּוּפָה can be vocalized either as הַצּוּפָה (masc.), or הַצּוּפָה (fem.; see #25, 6:2). Also, cf. [...] בְּאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת, "in/of (the) four side[s ...]" (7:5).

The drawings for the last word of line 9:7 differ. BAKER^{dr}: סומ or סימ, the *samekh* is much smaller than the *samekh* in the next line. MILIK^{dr}: ים (= ים). ALLEGRO^{dr}: סומ or סימ, the *samekh* is about the same size as the *samekh* in the next line. סימ = סים may be an unattested masculine form of סִמְאָה (fem., MH, A; also spelled as שִׁמְאָה), "treasure"; cf. מָה הַסִּמְאָה הַזֹּאת, "what is this treasure" (baraita y. 'A.Z. 2:7 [11a]; cf. Lurie); the Targum of וּשְׁפֹנֵי וְסִמְאָה דְּמִטְמָא בְּחָלָא, "and the hidden treasures of the sand," is וְסִמְאָה דְּמִטְמָא בְּחָלָא (TO), "and the treasure which is hidden in the sand," and וְסִמְאָה דְּמִטְמָא בְּחָלָא (PsJ), "and the treasures which are hidden in the sand" (Deut. 33:19); also, the Targum of מִטְמֹן (from the root טמן, "to hide") is סִמְאָה (PsJ, TN) and סִמְאָה (pl., TO), "treasure" (Gen. 43:23).¹¹ Regarding the vocalization,

10 Similar toponyms are: (a) חורונים, Horonaim, in southern Moab (Isa. 15:5), same as חורון in the Mesha Stone (KAI 1, 33 [#181:31]). (b) חורן, Hauran, in northeast of eastern Transjordan (Ezek. 47:16,18). (c) חרן, Haran, in Mesopotamia (Gen. 11:31). Many of these names are derived from חור, "hole," or are theophoric names for the Canaanite god Horon. Cf. BDB, 111b, 357a; G.A. Smith, *The Historical Geography of the Holy Land* (1974), 356, 408; SB, 102b-03a, 270a; KAI 1, 6; 2, 44 (#27:16). See also M. Avi-Yonah, "Bet(h)-Haron," *EJ* 4, 747-48; "Haronaim," *EJ* 8, 979-80; "בֵּית חורון" in *EH* 8, 606-07; J. Lebowitz and J.M. Grintz, "חור," *EH* 17, 210-11; S.E. Loewenstamm, "בֵּית חורון, בֵּית חרן," *EB* 2, 74-75; "חורונים, חרנים" in *EB* 3, 285; Z. Kalai, and H. Tadmor, "בית-חורון" in *EI* 9 (1969), 138-147, 138*. It is also possible to read as חורון, Horon, or חורין, Haran, that may be variant of the name חרן, Abraham's brother (Gen. 11:26-29,31), and of a Levite (1 Chron. 23:9); or the toponym בֵּית חָרָן, Beth-haran (Num. 32:36) = בֵּית הָרָם, Beth-haram, in Gad (Josh. 13:27). The Talmudim mention חורין Beth Hawran (y. Shevi. 9:1 [27a]; y. Sheq. 1:1 [3b]), בֵּית חורין, Valley of Beth Hawratan (b. Suk. 44a). Kohut identifies these places with Beth-horon of the Bible (*AC* 2, 69a). S. Klein assumes that בֵּית חורין was located in the mountain of חורין, Hawran (*SY* 1, 14a). The Court of Jerusalem had a signal station on the mountain top of חורין, Hawran, to proclaim the arrival of the New Moon for the Babylonian Jewry (m. R. ha-Sh. 2:4; t. R. ha-Sh. 2:2). See M. Avi-Yonah, "Hauran," *EJ* 7, 1476-77; Jastrow, 198a, 430b; *ETG* 1, 284-85; 2, 393-94.

11 Additional meanings of סִמְאָה are: "mark, sign" (e.g., TO Num. 32:3); "silver" (Trg. Ps. 12:7). The latter is from Persian; see Jastrow, 980b; A. Jellinek, "Sefat Chachamim" in

cf. שִׁיחַ (masc.) vs. שִׁיחָה (fem.; see #5, 1:13). Logically יַם, the reading of Milik's drawing, is a better than סוּמוֹסִימ, the reading of Baker's and Allegro's drawings (if so, then the *samekh* must be a scribal error).

יַם also occurs later, לִיְמֵי־יַם (see #55, 11:13). יַם (masc., pl. יָמִים) means: (1) "body of water"; cf. וַלְמָקוֹהַ הַיָּמִים קָרָא יַמִּים, "and He called the gatherings of the waters *yammim*" (Gen. 1:10);¹² (2) "sea" (Exod. 23:31); (3) "river" (Isa. 19:5); (4) "basin" (1 Kgs 7:23); and (5) "west," since the Mediterranean Sea is west of Palestine (Gen. 13:14). E.g., the Targum for אֶל רוּחַ הַיָּם, "to the direction of the sea," is לְרוּחַ מַעֲרָבָא, "to the west side" (Ezek. 42:19).¹³ Accordingly, בְּרוּחַ־בְּרוּחַ הַצּוּפָא־הַצּוּפָא יַם means, "in/at/by a/the direction which is facing (the) sea," i.e., "in the west side."

Scripture says, וַיֵּרֶד יַמָּה ... עַד גְּבוּל בֵּית חוֹרֵן תַּחְתּוֹן, "and (the border of the sons of Joseph) went down seaward/westward ... unto the border of Lower Beth-horon" (Josh. 16:3). The Mishnah says, "(the area) מִבֵּית חוֹרוֹן וְעַד הַיָּם (from Beth-horon till the sea is a single district)" (m. Shevi. 9:2). This is defined by the Talmud as, "מִבֵּית חוֹרוֹן עַד אַמְאָוִס (from Beth-horon till Ammaus), mountain; from Ammaus till Lod, slope; מִלּוֹד עַד הַיָּם (from Lod till the sea), valley" (y. Shevi. 9:2 [28a]).¹⁴ Accordingly, Beth-horon is located in the western part of Palestine. Moreover, the following citations speak about a burial place in Beth-horon or Beth Ḥorin.

Rabbi Yose said, "It happened בֵּסֶלַע בֵּית חוֹרִין (at the Cliff of Beth Ḥorin) which was known to be (ritually) unclean and because it was a slope, (the sages) could not examine it. An old sage told them, "Bring me a sheet." They brought him a sheet, and he soaked it in water and spread it out upon (the cliff), and it turned out that the side areas became לֵחַ (wet) while the center area dry. (The sages) examined (the area) and found there בּוֹר גָּדוֹל מְלֵא מֵתִים (a large pit full of corpses)" (t. Nid. 8:7).

It was taught (in a baraita): Abba Saul says, "It happened בֵּסֶלַע בֵּית חוֹרוֹן (at the Cliff of Beth-horon) which was known to be (ritually) unclean and the sages could not examine it because of its dimension. And an old sage happened to be there, and his name was Rabbi Joshua ben Hanania. He told them, "Bring me sheets." They brought him sheets, and he soaked them in water and

Debarim Attikim 2 (1846), 34.

12 And so the Targumim, וּלְבֵית כְּנִישֵׁת מִיָּא קָרָא יַמִּי (TO), וּלְבֵית כְּנִישֵׁת מִיָּא קָרָא יַמִּי (PsJ), וּלְבֵית כְּנִישֵׁת מִיָּא קָרָא יַמִּי (TN).

13 When יַם means "west" the Targumim render מַעֲרָבָא, "the west." In such cases Rashi frequently explains יַם as "west"; e.g., רוּחַ יַם, "western wind" (Exod. 10:19; see also Rashbam, Ibn-Ezra, and *Ma'amar Yom-Tov*).

14 The Zhitomir edition of the Palestinian Talmud has אַמְאָוִס, a final *mem* instead of *samekh*. According to Jastrow (74b), אַמְאָוִס, אֵימָאָוִס (also אַמְאָוִס, etc.), Ἐμμαούς, Ἐμμαούς, Emmaus, Ammaus is the Hellenized name of חֲמָה, חֲמַתָּא. According to Kohut, there were several toponyms with these names (AC 1, 112).

spread them out upon (the questionable areas). The (ritually) clean area dry, (but) the (ritually) unclean area became wet. (The sages) examined (the wet area) and they found עֲצָמוֹת מְלֵא גְדוֹל בּוֹר (a large pit full of [human] bones) (b. Nid. 61a).

Both sources relate the same story, each providing extra information. As it turned out, the Cliff of Beth-horon/Hōrin was indeed ritually unclean since it had a large pit containing human corpses or bones. This large pit might had been one of the הַחֹרֹן/הַחֹרִין, צְרִיחֵי הַחֹרֹן/הַחֹרִין, “the catacombs of Horon/Horin,” of the Scroll, especially since the Targum renders וּבְצִרְחֵים וּבְמַעְרַת טִינָא as “in the cave of the rock,” i.e., in the cave hewn in the rock (1 Sam. 13:6), just as the pit hewn in the rock of this story (see #8, 2:5-6).

(9:8) בְּצִרְחֵי הַחֹרֹן, “in/at/by a/the canal,” can also be read as בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן, “in/at/by a/the bottom/side.” Thus, this item can be read as, בְּצִרְחֵי הַחֹרֹן ... בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן, “At/by/between/among (the) catacombs/towers of Horon ... at/by a/the canal,” or בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן ... בְּצִרְחֵי הַחֹרֹן, “At/by/between/among the catacombs/towers of Horon ... in a/the side.” Cf. the possible readings of בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן ... בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן, “In/at/by the great cistern ... in/at/by a/the side of its bottom,” or בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן ... בְּצִרְכֵּי הַחֹרֹן, “In/at/by the great cistern ... in/at/by a/the canal of its ground” (1:6-7). Regarding יָרֵךְ and וֶרֶב, see #3, 1:7; #5, 3:13; #14, 3:11.

(9:8) 22 חֲפֹרִיחֲפֹר אֲמוֹת שֵׁשׁ עָסְרָה כֹּחַ, “are buried sixteen cubits (deep) 22 s(ilver) k(arsh),” or “dig sixteen cubits (deep, there are) 22 s(ilver) k(arsh)”;

cf. TP 40 חֲפֹרִיחֲפֹר אֲמוֹת שֵׁשׁ עָסְרָה כֶּסֶף כֹּחַ, “are buried/dig sixteen cubits (deep, there are) 40 s(ilver) k(arsh) silver. (Code:) TP” (#12, 3:6-7).

In the drawings the word אֲמוֹת differ. ALLEGRO's has אֲמוֹת. However, BAKER's and MILIK's have אֲמֵת, where the separated left part of the *mem* plus the next *waw* looks like an *ayin*; cf. אֲמֵת or אֲמֵת for אֲמוֹת (see #47, 10:9). These are obvious scribal errors. Regarding אֲמֵת, see #1, 1:2-3.

The scholars read the next word as עֲסָרָה.¹⁵ The word itself appears in the three drawings as עֲסָרָה, *waw* instead of a *reš*. There are several possible explanations for this phenomenon. The *waw* could be: (a) a scribal error; (b) a short-headed *reš*; (c) a short-legged final *nun* in medial position. The latter could be explained as a *nun-reš* interchange, i.e., עֲסָרָה = עֲסָרָה = עֲסָרָה. For similar cases in the Scroll, see #38, 9:1-2; for חֲפֹר, #17, 4:7; for עֲסָרָה, Appendix B; for כֹּחַ, Appendix A.

15 Allegro^{fr} notes that שֵׁשׁ עֲסָרָה is an error for שֵׁשׁ עֲסָרָה; Allegro, 49, 158 n. 207 (the scribe wrote a *yod* instead of a *reš*); Allegro^{ev}, 25; Milik, 293; Lurie, 108; Pixner, 352. Qimron (spelled עֲסָרָה for עֲסָרָה), “We’od Hiddah,” 518-19; Wolters, 48-49; Garcia Martinez, 462; Beyer, 229, 231; Vermes, 376; Wise, 197.

ITEM 41

9:10 בקובע הכסף מן החרם

9:10 In Qova^c (there are unspecified amount of) silver of consecrated (matter).

COMMENTARY

(9:10) בקובע הכסף מן החרם, "In (the) Qova^c (the) silver is of consecrated (matter)" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "in the grain-pit (?), much silver of 'free will offering'" (i.e., בקומעה כסף מנחה רב). בקומעה, cf. Aramaic קומצא, "grain-pit." ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the nest, silver from the *Herem*." ALLEGRO: בקומעה כסף מן החרם, "In the 'funnel': silver from the consecrated offerings." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the funnel, much silver of free will offering," i.e., בקובעה כסף מנחה רב (cf. Allegro^{pr}).¹ MILIK: בקובעה כסף מנח הרב, "At Qob'eh, a large quantity of silver has been stored." Qob'eh may be identical with the village el-Qabu to the southwest of Jerusalem. Alternately, בקובעה כסף מנחה רב, "At Qob'eh, much silver of free will offering" (cf. Allegro^{pr}). Other possibilities are קובע and קומע.² LURIE: בקימעה כסף מנחת רב, "Silver of many offerings bounded in a bundle"; this line is connected with the next item.³ PIXNER: "At Qubeyeh (בקובעה) there is much silver deposited." The village Qubeyeh/Kuveyeh still exists on the northern edge of the Yarmuk Valley, close to Beth-ere.⁴ THORION: קובעה (as Milik).⁵ WOLTERS: בקומעה כסף מנח החרם, "In its funnel: a mina of silver, consecrated offering"; cf. כסף מנח, "minas of silver" (Ezra 2:69; Neh. 7:70-71).⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "In Qob'ah: a mina of silver, a sacred offering."⁷ BEYER: בקובעה כסף מנחה רב, or (?) בקובעה כסף מן החרם, "in a 'cup' (and) in a large offering bowl"; or "in a 'cup' (and) in a silver cup of banned goods." This is the last line of the previous item.⁸ VERMES: "At Qobah a large amount of money offerings (?)."⁹ WISE: "At the Pass: silver coins totaling one mina, and consecrated

1 Allegro, 49; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 214, 293-94, 230 B-15b, 254 C-151-2, 269 D-33, 301 Addenda to 269 D-33; Milik^E, 141, 150.

3 Lurie, 109-10.

4 Pixner, 252 and n. 35.

5 Thorion, 165.

6 "Notes," 595-96; "Analysis," 250; Wolters, 48-49.

7 Garcia Martinez, 462.

8 Beyer, 229-31.

Temple offering.”¹⁰

This item demonstrates the difficulty of both reading and interpreting the Scroll. It consists of one line having fifteen letters making up four words, yet there is only one word separation between the second and third one. Some letters can be read in more than one way. The first letter is the preposition *bet* (rather than *kaf*), as in fifty-two items in the Scroll. The third letter is a *waw/yod*. The fifth is a *bet/mem*. The sixth and the twelfth are *he/het/taw*, which may belong to the previous word, but logically it is a *he*, the definite article of the next word. The eleventh is a medial *nun* which depending on the word separation may be in final position. The last letter is a *bet* or *mem*.

In addition, it is possible that this line is the first part of the next item (cf. Lurie), or the last line of the previous item (cf. Beyer). Various possible readings are as follows.

בְּקֹבֶעָה־בְּקֹבֶעָה or בְּקֹבֶעָה־בְּקֹבֶעָה for בְּקֹבֶעָה־בְּקֹבֶעָה, “in/at/by a/the fixed gravestone” — The root קבע (MH, JA) means “to fix, stick into, insert.” In the Talmud קֹבֶעָה, “inserted stone,” i.e., “fixed gravestone,” is an antonym for אָבֶן תְּלוּשָׁה, “loose stone,” i.e., “detached gravestone.”¹¹ קֹבֶעָה and קִיבָעָה may be variants for קֹבֶעָה; cf. כּוּפְרִין and כִּיפְרִין for כּוּפְרִין, “bowls” (see #47, 10:11), הַבּוֹאֵת for הַבּוֹאֵת (see #1, 1:2). קֹבֶעָה or קִיבָעָה could be an additional ‘burial’ term used in the Scroll, such as קֶבֶר, “grave,” נַפֶּשׁ, “tomb,” בֵּית הַמֶּשְׁכָּב, “mausoleum.”

בְּקֹבֶעָה־בְּקֹבֶעָה, “in (the) Qova^c,” or בְּקֹבֶעָה־בְּקֹבֶעָה, “in (the) Qove‘ah” — קֹבֶעָה - קֹבֶעָה may be a toponym. This suggestion is supported by Rabbinic sources and archaeological evidence. קֹבֶעָה - קֹבֶעָה may be identical with similar place names from the list that describes “the border of the Land of Israel,” i.e., the area which the returnees of Babylon took in their possession. (1) קִיבֵּי רַעִיָּא (t. Shevi. 4:11); some manuscripts and editions have קֹבֶעָה־רַעִיָּא. (2) קִיבֵּי רַעִיָּא (Sifri 51 on Deut. 11:24). (3) קֹבֶעָה־רַעִיָּא (y. Shevi. 6:1 [17b]). (4) קִיבֵּי רַעִיָּא (Yalqut Šim‘oni #874 on Deut. 11:23); some manuscripts and editions have קֹבֶעָה־רַעִיָּא. (5) קֹבֶעָה־רַעִיָּא (Rehob Inscription, line 14). The latter is corrected by Sussmann as קֹבֶעָה־רַעִיָּא.¹² (See also the next suggestions.)

9 Vermes, 376.

10 Wise, 196.

11 E.g., “Rabbi Ila in the name of Rabbi Samuel bar Nahmani (expounded the verse), ‘and the travelers will pass by in the land and will see אָדָם וּבְנֵה אֶצְלוֹ צִיּוֹן (a human bone and will build next to it a sign)’ (Ezek. 39:15); אֶצְמָ, this indicates that one must mark the bones (that they are ritually unclean); אָדָם, this indicates that one must mark the spine and the skull; וּבְנֵה אֶצְלוֹ, this indicates that it must be marked בְּקֹבֶעָה אָבֶן (a fixed gravestone), if you say that also אָבֶן תְּלוּשָׁה (a loose gravestone, [it cannot be since]), it moves and it would make impure other areas; אֶצְמָ, indicates that (the monument must be put next to the grave) at a pure area; צִיּוֹן, this indicates that (the grave) must have a sign” (y. Sheq. 1:1 [3b]; for אָבֶן קֹבֶעָה, see *Qorban ha‘Edah*); cf. y. Ma‘as. Sh. 5:1 [20b]). See also #47, 10:9.

בְּקוֹבְעָה־בְּקוֹבְעָה, בְּקוֹבְעָה־בְּקוֹבְעָה, or בְּקוֹבְעָה־בְּקוֹבְעָה, “in/at/by a/the dome/hill” — קוֹבֵעַ (masc.), “helmet” (2 Sam. 17:38; Ezek. 23:24), is related to כוֹבֵעַ (masc.), “hat, helmet” (e.g., 1 Sam. 17:5; m. ‘Ed. 2:4), כוֹבְעָה (or כוֹבְעָה, כוֹבְעָה; fem.), “top [of stalks of sheaves]” (e.g., Pe’ah 5:8),¹³ and מְגַבַּעַת, “(priestly) head-cover” (e.g., Exod. 28:40), from the root גִּבַּע, “to be arched” (*gimmel-kaf-qof* interchanges).¹⁴

In addition, גִּבְעָה, Geba, and גִּבְעָה, Gibeah, are biblical toponyms.¹⁵ The latter, גִּבְעָה (fem.), means “hill” (2 Sam. 2:25, etc.). Similarly, Jastrow renders קוֹבְעָא דְעֵייתָא as “Qob’ayya (Tops or Hollows) of Aitha.”¹⁶ This suggestion can be compared to כִּיפָּה, “dome” in the Scroll (see #24, 5:12).

בְּקוֹמַעַה־בְּקוֹמַעַה, “in (the) Qoma’,” or בְּקוֹמַעַה־בְּקוֹמַעַה, “in (the) Qome’ah” — קוֹמַעַה could be unattested toponyms. The root קמַע is related to קמַץ, “to press, fasten, knit” (*tet/ayin/šade* interchanges).¹⁷

The last three words of this difficult item can be read, vocalized, and translated as follows.

הַכֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶם, “(the) silver is of the consecrated (matter),” or “(there is an unspecified amount) of consecrated silver.

הַכֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶם, “one silver (piece/shekel) from the consecrated (matter),” i.e., there is only one consecrated silver piece. This suggestion is unlikely.

הַכֶּסֶף מִנָּה חֶרֶם (Wolters), “one silver mina, (it is) consecrated,” i.e., “one consecrated silver mina,” or הַכֶּסֶף מִנָּה חֶרֶם, “the silver (is) one mina, (it is) consecrated,” i.e., “the silver is one consecrated mina.” The plural of מִנָּה (masc.), “mina,” is a certain weight, מִנִּין, occurs in the Scroll (see #59,

12 Sussmann lists about twelve cases in the Rehob Inscription where *reš* is a scribal error for *dalet* and *dalet* for *reš*. For variant Tosephta readings, see Zuckerman, 66, note to line 7; P. Neaman, *Boundaries of Eretz-Israel According to Hasal* (1978), 32. Klein reads in the Sifre as קְבִיָּא דְעֵייתָא (SY, 160). F. Vitto, “בית הכנסת של רחוב” in *Atiqot* 7 (1974), 103, pls. xxxvi-xxxvii; Y. Sussmann, “כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן” in *Tarbiz* 43 (1973/74), 96, 158, the photograph of the inscription and transcription of the text is on an unnumbered page); “בְּרִייתָא דְתַחֲוִי אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל” in *Tarbiz* 45 (1975/76), 230 and n. 98. The Talmud mentions קוֹבִי, a place name in Palestine; “when they came to קוֹבִי (or קוֹבִי, Qove or Quve) they said, קוֹם בֵּיה (stand up against him), when they came to בֵּי תַרִי (Bei-Taray) they said, קוֹם בֵּיה (between two) lion cubs kill the lion” (b. San. 95a, referring to 2 Sam. 21:17). קוֹבִי - בֵּי תַרִי (between two) lion cubs kill the lion” (b. San. 95a, referring to 2 Sam. 21:17). קוֹם בֵּיה - בֵּי תַרִי are word plays. For variant readings, see Jastrow, 169a, 227a. Rashi comments that קוֹבִי is a village between Israel and Philistine, and that בֵּי תַרִי is a place name (b. San. 95a).

13 Regarding these vocalizations, see BY 3, 2277a n. 1.

14 Cf. SB 129a, 357a, 361b, 731b.

15 גִּבְעָה is a city in northern Judah (2 Kgs 23:8); a Priestly city in Benjamin (1 Kgs 15:22; etc.), same as גִּבְעָה (Judg. 19:14, etc.); גִּבְעָה, a city in Judah (Josh. 15:57, etc.); גִּבְעָא, a settlement in Judah (1 Chron. 2:49); etc.

16 Jastrow, 1324a.

17 The suggestions קוֹמַעַה, “funnel” (Allegro), קוֹמַעַה, as an unattested nominal form of קמַע, “bundle, package” (Lurie), and קמִיַע, “amulet” (e.g., m. Shab. 8:3), can be rejected.

12:9; Appendix A). E.g., וְכֶסֶף מִנִּים ... וְכֶסֶף מִנִּים, "And some of the heads of the families donated to the treasury of the work [of the Temple] ... and two thousand and two hundred silver minas" (Neh. 7:70).

הָרֵם (masc.) appears in two additional cases in the Scroll (9:16, 11:7). It has several meanings, but only two Mishnaic usages appear to be relevant: "dedicated (object) to the priests" for private use, and "dedicated (object) for repair of the Temple." הָרֵם, "consecrated (object)," is a synonym of דָּמַע, "dedicated (object)," תְּרוּמָה, "elevated gift, priestly share," קֹדֶשׁ and הִקְדֵּשׁ, "sanctified (object)" (see #52, 11:17; Appendix D).

הַכֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶב or כֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶב, "(the) silver is from the sword/army/war," or "(there is) silver from the sword/army/war." חֶרֶב means "dry place, ruin" (cf. חֲרִיבָא, #1, 1:1), "sword," also "army, war, corpse."

הַכֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶב or כֶּסֶף מִן הַחֶרֶב, "(the) silver is of sword mina," where מִן הַחֶרֶב (= מִן הַחֶרֶב שֶׁל הַחֶרֶב), "sword mina," could be a special type of mina used during a war. Various types of minas existed in the Talmudic era.

It was asked by (the scholars), "We learned in the Mishnah מִן הַחֶרֶב (Tyrian mina), or we learned in the Mishnah מִן הַחֶרֶב (country mina)?" (b. B.Q. 90b, referring to m. B.Q. 8:6).

The last two possibilities may suggest that silver put aside for or received from the army or war had been deposited in this cache. If this assumption is correct, then one could speculate which war is being referred in this item. It could possibly be the war against the Roman oppressors.

Finally, following Lurie, it is possible to read, although with an unusual word order, this item and the next one as a single entity. Accordingly, the total deposit of both items would consist of 9 karsh of consecrated silver.

ITEM 42

9:11 בקילח מימ הקרובין לכפ הביב
 9:12 מרחב לפיהמ חפור אמות
 9:13 שבע ככ 9

- 9:11 At the water stream that comes near to the edge of the drain,
 9:12 (there is) an open area at its orifice, (there) are buried seven
 9:13 cubits (deep) 9 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

This is an extremely difficult item. Almost every word can be read more than one way. Also, grouping some letters into words are very complicated.

(9:11) **הַבִּיב הַכֶּף לְכַפּוֹלֵחַ מִיַּם הַקְּרוּבִים הַקְּרִיבִין**, “In/at/by a/(the) water stream that comes near to the edge of the drain” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the compartment of the waters which run to the trough of the canal” (i.e., **בְּקִיל הַמִּיָּם**, **בְּקִיל הַמִּיָּם**, “compartment, enclosure”; the closely related **קוֹלָא** (A) also means “bowl.” **הַקְּרוּבִין** or **הַקְּרִיבִין**, “approaching,” i.e., “running to.” **כַּפֶּת**, the “hollow” of a gutter or canal. **בִּיב**, “gutter, pipe, or canal; in 12:8 a duct of a censor. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the outlet (?) of the waters which run to the arch of a sewer gutter” (i.e., **מִיַּם הַקְּרוּבִין**, “In the pipe of waters that run to the basin of the drain”; the last *he* looks like a *taw*. **קִיל**, “hollow tree stem” (Jastrow, 1359b), thus, “pipe”; **כֶּף**, “basin”; the following apparent *taw* is the definite article *he* of the next word (i.e., **הַבִּיב**). Alternatively, **בְּקִילַח מִיָּם**, “water jet.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the pipe of waters that run to the trough of the drain.”¹ MILIK: **בְּקוֹל הַמִּיָּם הַקְּרוּבִין לְכַפְרֵנֹבּוּ**, “At the waterfall a short distance from Kephars Nebo”; the *reš* and *nun* form a ligature that resembles a *taw*. Alternatively, **כַּפָּר נָבִי** (= **כַּפָּר נָבִיא**), “Village of the Prophet”; a possible identification for its location is suggested.² LURIE: **קִילַח מִיָּם**, “In the water canal near its edge.” **כֶּף** refers to one of the many man made water canals in the Valley of Jericho.

¹ Allegro, 49, 158 nn. 211-13; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

² Milik, 294-95, 242 C-54, 265-66 D-21; Milik^E, 141.

is related to כִּפְתָּא (A), “edge, bank.” כַּף הַבֵּיב, “the edge of the water canal or of the stream.”³ PIXNER: בְּקִילַח מֵיִם הַקְּרוּבִין לַכַּף הַבֵּיב, “At the water rapids that exist close to the mouth of the sewage canal.” There are several water rapids along the Upper Yarmuk.⁴ WOLTERS: בְּקִילַח הַמֵּיִם הַקְּרוּבִין לַכַּף הַבֵּיב, “In the outflow of the waters which are close to the edge of the drain.”⁵ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the waterfalls near the edge of the conduit.”⁶ BEYER: בְּכַף הַבֵּיב, “In the curve of the waters, which is located near an arch of a canal.”⁷ VERMES: “At ‘the sound of waters’ (waterfall) close to the edge of the gutter.”⁸ WISE: “At the wellspring near the edge of the aqueduct.”⁹

קִילוּחַ מֵיִם = בְּקִילוּחַ מֵיִם, “at/by a/(the) water stream” — (MH, masc.) and קִילוּחָא (the Targum for זָרַם, Job 24:8) mean “stream, jet” of liquid (from the root קלח, “to flow, stream”). E.g.,

(If) the seller says, “I sell you חֲצֵר וּמָה שֶׁבְּתוֹכָהּ (a courtyard and what is in it)” ... (the buyer) has no property right to the water pipe בְּחֲצֵר (in the courtyard), (but to) מְקוֹם קִילוּחוֹ (the place of its stream), he has property right (t. B.B. 2:13).

And so is (the case) when five חֲצֵרוֹת (courtyards) אֶחָד הַבֵּיב (the drain basin), all (owners must) repair it (together) with the (owner of the) lower-most one (baraita, b. B.M. 108a).

(If) the בּוֹר (pit [of wine]) became forbidden (by being dedicated to idolatry), (then) the קִילוּחַ (jet [of the wine]) became forbidden (too); (but if) the קִילוּחַ (jet) became forbidden, (then) the בּוֹר (pit [of wine]) did not become forbidden” (y. ‘A.Z. 4:8 [20a]).¹⁰

Rabban Simon ben Gamaliel taught (in a Baraita): “שִׁילוּחַ הָיָה מִקְלַח מֵיִם” ([The] Siloam [Spring] used to gush water) through an *issar* (a coin) sized (opening). The king ordered and they enlarged it that its water should increase, but it diminished. And they reversed and decreased it (i.e., the opening), וְהָיָה מִקְלַח מֵיִם and (consequently) it gushed water (as before)” (b. ‘Arakh. 10b).

It can also be read as בְּקִיל הַמֵּיִם (Allegro) or בְּקוֹל הַמֵּיִם (Milik). Both קִיל (pl. קִילִין) and קוֹל (pl. קוֹלִין) mean “compartment, room, enclosure, prison” (cf. Allegro^{pr}). E.g., God commanded Noah, קְנִים תַּעֲשֶׂה אֶת הַתֵּבָה, “make the Ark with compartments” (Gen. 6:14). קְנִים (קְנִי) is the plural of קֶן (masc., const. קֶן), “nest, compartment.” קְנִים is rendered by Onkelos as

3 Lurie, 109-10 and nn. 3-4 (there are several typographical errors in this item).

4 Pixner, 353 and n. 36, pl. iv.

5 “Vocabulary,” 489; “Analysis,” 250; Wolters, 48-49.

6 Garcia Martinez, 462.

7 Beyer, 230-31.

8 Vermes, 376.

9 Wise, 196.

10 In these citations the nominal and verbal forms of קלח, as well as בֵּיב and מֵיִם occur.

מְדוֹרִין, and by Rashi as מְדוֹרִים, “living quarters.” Similarly, the Midrash explains the word קָנִים as קוֹלִין וּמְדוֹרִין, “rooms and living quarters,” and as קִילִין, “rooms,” adding that וְקִיל שֵׁשׁ אַמּוֹת עַל שֵׁשׁ אַמּוֹת, “and a room is six cubits by six cubits” (Gen. Rabbah 31:9,11). קִילִין is defined by Pseudo-Rashi as חֲדָרִים, “rooms” (cf. Yalqut Šim‘oni, Noah 6:53-54). Moreover, קִילִין בֵּית קוֹלִין means “prison” (Songs Rabbah 8:15). Their Aramaic cognates are, קִילָא (pl. קִילִין), קִילִיא, קִילָא (pl. קִילִין). E.g., “one hundred and fifty קוֹלִין (rooms) you shall make for the ark” (PsJ Gen. 6:14); “You, the congregation of Israel who is compared לְגִנְתָּא קִילִיא (to an enclosed garden) among the nations” (Trg. Songs 8:13).

Kohut derives קִיל from the Greek *χέλλα* and Latin *cella*, “cell, compartment, room.”¹¹ Even-Shoshan suggests that קוֹלִין (sg.) may be a variant of בִּלָּא, “prison”¹² (*kaf-qof* interchange). Yet קִיל - קִילִין, as well as קוֹל - קוֹלִין are simply variants of קָן - קָנִים (BH, MH), a *lamed-nun* interchange. E.g., “Rabbi Simon says, ‘The abdomen of the woman is made of קִינִין (various compartments)’” (Lev. Rabbah 14).

קִיל may be a shortened form of קִילוֹן. E.g., “but it is not permitted to water (a garden on half-festival day) מִמֵּי הַקִּילוֹן וְלֹא מִמֵּי הַגֶּשֶׁמִּים (neither from the rain water nor from the water of a *qilon*)” (m. Mo‘ed Q. 1:1). קִילוֹן is a “deep pit, well,” and מִי קִילוֹן is a body of “water of a deep pit.”¹³ קִילָא (A) means “stone, clod.” E.g., בִּירָא דְשִׁתִּית מִיבִיהָ קִילָא אֶל תְּשַׁדִּי בִיהָ, “A well from which you drink, do not throw a clod into it” (b. B.Q. 52b).

Accordingly, the possible explanations for קִיל - קוֹל are: (1) “canal,” cf. אַמָּה, “canal” (4:3, etc.); (2) “deep pit,” cf. שׁוּחַשׁ־הַשִּׁית, “(deep) pit” (3:8, etc.); (3) “clod,” cf. רֶגֶב, “clod” (5:9, 6:8, alt.); (4) “enclosure,” cf. הֶצֶר, “courtyard,” (1:6, etc.); (5) “room,” cf. דִּירַת, “room of” (11:16, restored), and דִּיר, “room” (8:14, alt.).

מֵי, “waters,” or הַמֵּי, “the waters” — Although מֵי, a masculine noun with dual formation, is always plural, it is often rendered in the singular. מֵי occurs in the Scroll in two additional places: עַל פִּי יִצְיֵאת הַמֵּי, “above/upon the mouth/opening of the water spring” (see #32, 7:14); and בְּיַם בֵּית הַמֵּי,

11 AC 7, 93b-95a.

12 ESh^{dic} 6, 2306a.

13 Rabbeinu Hananel, *Haggahot habBah* (on b. Mo‘ed Q. 4a); Bertinoro, *Tosephot Yom-Tov*, *Tif‘erei Israel*, Kehati (on m. Mo‘ed Q. 1:1; m. Miq. 8:1); *Meleḥket Šelomoh* (on m. Miq. 8:1). *Tosephot Yom-Tov* says in the name of Ran that *qilon* originates from קוֹלֶתָא, the Targum for כֶּרֶךְ (Gen. 24:15), “pitcher” (m. Mo‘ed Q. 1:1). According to *He‘Arukh* (495b), קִילִין is “water pump,” קִילוֹן is a “channel” where water is drawn; while others say that מִי קִילוֹן is a “deep pit with shallow water.” Kohut vocalizes as קִילוֹן, from *χῆλων*, “pump”; also mentions *χοιλάς*, “deep pit,” and *χῆλῶν*, “canal” (AC, 7, 103). According to Jastrow (1360a), קִילוֹן is from the Greek *χῆλῶν*, and it is “swipe and bucket for drawing water.” Albeck says that קִילוֹן is a Greek word for a pump to draw water from a deep well (see Kehati on m. Mo‘ed Q. 1:1; m. Miq. 8:1; m. Makhsh. 4:9).

"in/at/by (the) pool of (the) water-closet/laundry" (see #49, 10:15).

הַקְרִיבִין = הַקְרִיבִין (*plene, Qal* act. part. masc. pl., plus the definite article) means, "that are coming near" (cf. Allegro). הַקְרִיבִין (adj. masc. pl., plus the definite article) means, "which are near" (cf. the scholars). Both forms are derived from the root קרב, "to come near." Both can be found in the Masoretic Text: הֵמָּה בְּנֵי צָדוֹק הַקְרִיבִים לְיְיָ אֵל ה' לְשָׁרְתוֹ, "they are the sons of Zadok among the sons of Levi who come near to the Lord to serve Him" (Ezek. 40:46); and הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלֵּוִיִּם אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִזֶּרַע צָדוֹק הַקְרִיבִים אֵלַי, "the priests (of) the Levites which are from the seed of Zadok, which are near to Me" (Ezek. 43:19).

מֵיִם וְרִים or הַקְרִיבִין (pl.) is in apposition to מֵיִם or הַמֵּיִם (pl.); cf. הַמֵּיִם הַיְדֵּרִים, "strange, cool, (and) flowing waters" (Jer. 18:14); קָרִים נוֹזְלִים מִלְּמַעְלָה, "the waters that are descending from above" (Josh. 3:13,16).

It is also possible to read as בְּקִילִבְקוֹל הַחֲמִים הַקְרִיבִים הַקְרִיבִים, "in the compartment (where) the hot (waters) come/are near," or "in the hot (waters) compartment (where the waters) come/are near"; cf. בְּיַם בֵּית הַחֲמִים, "in/at/by (the) pool of (the) hot bath/spring/house," where חֲמִים means "hot waters" (see #49, 10:15, alt.). Accordingly, קוֹל חֲמִים, "room of hot (waters)," and בֵּית חֲמִים, literally "house of hot (waters)," are synonyms.

כֶּף consists of the preposition *lamed*, "at, to, toward," plus the noun כֶּף in the construct state. כֶּף can be vocalized and interpreted as follows: (1) כֶּף or כֶּף (masc., MH), "shore, bank, border of."¹⁴ (2) כֶּף (masc., pl. בְּפִים, BH, MH), "rock, stone, ball of" (see #24, 5:12, where כֶּפָא could be a feminine form of כֶּף). (3) כֶּף (fem., dual בְּפִים, pl. בְּפוֹת, BH), "hollow, palm (of the hand), sole (of the foot), branch (of the tree), pan of"; e.g., וְלֹא מָצְאָה, "but the dove found no place for the sole of her foot" (Gen. 8:9). These nouns are derived from the root כָּפַח, "to bend."

הַבֵּיב, "the drain" — Both בֵּיב (masc., pl. בֵּיבִים, MH) and the rarely used בֵּיבָא (fem, pl. בֵּיבוֹת, MH) mean "drain, gutter, pipe, duct, sewer, canal, underground walk"; they are related to נָבוֹב (adj. masc.), "hollow, empty" (Jer. 42:21; Job 11:12), from the root נָבַב, "to hollow."¹⁵ The Aramaic cognate of בֵּיב is בֵּיבָא (emph., prob. masc.); e.g., וְעָלָה מִן בֵּיבָא דְּמִדְנָתָא, "he entered (Bethar) through the sewer of the city" (y. Ta'an. 4:4 [21a]).

בֵּיבָא also appears in the Scroll: בְּבֵיבָא וּבֵיבָא הַגְדוֹלָא שֶׁל הַבֵּיב, "in/at/by the large drain of the Bezek" (see #59, 12:8); הַבֵּיבָא שֶׁל מָנֹס, "the drain of Manos" (see #5, 1:13, alt.); עַל פִּי יְצִיאַת הַמֵּיִם שֶׁל הַבֵּיבָא, "in/at/by the mouth of the water exit of the drain" (see #32, 7:14, alt.); בְּמַעְרָא וּבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל

14 כֶּף is related to כָּב - גָּב, "back" (*gimmel-kaf* and *bet-waw-pe* interchanges).

15 Cf. ESh^{dic} 1, 213a; but Ben-Yehuda (1, 521a n.1) disagrees. According to Jastrow (136a, 159a), בֵּיב is related to the Aramaic בְּבִיבָא וּבְבִיבָא, "entrance, door, gate," which is a reduplicated form of בָּא from the root בָּא, "to come, go." Kohut recognized the feminine בֵּיבָא (AC 2, 5), while others overlooked it.

הַבָּא, “in/at/by a/the cave of the drain” (see #26, 6:7, alt.); and [בְּבִי]בָא-שְׁבִדְרָךְ, “[in/at/by a/the dr]ain which is in/at/by (the) road (of)” (see #33, 8:1, alt.).

The following citations demonstrate the Mishnaic Hebrew usage for both בִּיבָה and בִּיבָה.

Rabbi Eliezer ben Jacob says, “בִּיבָה (a drain) that is covered for four cubits (length) in the public domain, one may pour waste water into it (on Sabbath)”; while the sages say, “even if a roof or a courtyard is one hundred cubits (long) one shall not pour (waste water) עַל פִּי הַבִּיבָה (upon the opening of the drain); but one may pour (waste water) on the roof although the water runs down into the בִּיבָה (drain)” (m. ‘Eruv. 8:10).

Rashi explains בִּיבָה as “הָרֵיץ (a ditch) that is made שְׁבִחָרָה (to flow of waste water which is in the courtyard) into the public thoroughfare” (b. ‘Eruv. 88a). The term חֲרוֹצֵה־חֵרֶץ occurs in the Scroll (5:8).

As it was learned (in a baraita): All of these (cases) that (the Sages) said (regarding those who) פּוֹתְקִין בִּיבֹתֵיהֶן (open their sewers) וְגוֹרְפִין מְעֻרֹתֵיהֶן (and/or they clean out their caves [into the public thoroughfare], in the days of summer they have no right to do so, in the days of the rains they have right to do do. [In the latter case] although they have right to do so, if they cause damage, they are responsible for it (b. B.Q. 6a, 30a; see Rashi).

Since *bet* and *kaf*, as well as *waw* and *yod* are often indistinguishable in the Scroll, הַבִּיבָה can also be read as הַכּוֹבֵהכּוֹב, “the burial niche.” Regarding כָּה, see #24, 5:12; for כּוֹךְ, #59, 12:8.

Based on the above discussion, the phrase in question can be read, vocalized, and interpreted as follows.

לְכַף הַבִּיבָה = לְכַף הַבִּיבָה or לְכַף הַבִּיבָה = “at/to shore/bank of the drain.”

לְכַף הַבִּיבָה = לְכַף הַבִּיבָה, “at/to the rock/stone/ball of the drain.”

לְכַף הַבִּיבָה = לְכַף הַבִּיבָה, “at/to (the) hollow-section/cave of the drain,” or “at/to the bottom of the drain.”

לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב = לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב or לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב = “at/to the edge of the burial niche.”

לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב = לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב, “at/to the rock/stone of the burial niche.”

לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב = לְכַף הַכּוֹבֵה־הַכּוֹב, “at/to the hollow-section of the burial niche,” or “at/to the bottom of the burial niche.”

— מְרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם (9:12), “(there is) an open area at/to their/its orifice” — ALLEGRO^{PT} (with the rest of the item): “from outside to the mouth of the excavated hole (there are) seven cubits, *kk* 9” (i.e., שִׁבְעַת אַמּוֹת שְׁבַע, מְרָחֵב לְפִי הַמַּחְפּוֹר).

9 ככ).¹⁶ ALLEGRO^{Pr}: "(these being) from the outside to their mouth" (i.e., מרחב לפיהם; cf. Allegro^{rev}). ALLEGRO: מרחב לפיהם, "from the wide part toward their mouth"; either *rahav*, "wide," or *rehov*, "open place." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "from the outside toward their mouth."¹⁷ MILIK: במזרח, "near its outlet to the east" (the *bet* is from the previous line). כלפיהם כלפיהם is like כלבית הברך, "(going) towards Beth ha-Baruk," with the prefixed preposition כל, "near"; cf. כלפי (A), "against, opposite."¹⁸ It should be added that כלפי (also MH; e.g. m. Mid. 3:6), a shortened form כלפי, is not used with suffixes.¹⁹ LURIE: מרחב לפנים, "in the wide section inward." לפנים is rendered as כלפי (cf. Milik).²⁰ To read לפנים one must change the *he* into a *yod* or to disregard the *he* altogether. PIXNER: מרחב לפיהם (cf. Allegro), "there is a wide space at its mouth."²¹ WOLTERS: מרחב לפניהם, "a wide space in front of them."²² GARCIA MARTINEZ: "to the East of its outlet."²³ BEYER: מרחב לפניהם, "of (a greater) width, in front of it (= the water)."²⁴ VERMES: "on the east side of the exit."²⁵ WISE: "on the east over against the wellspring."²⁶

מרחב consists of either the preposition *mem*, "from/of/in/at," plus the noun רחב (masc.); or a locative *mem* plus רחב. The root רחב means, "to be/-grow wide." For this word the following possibilities are offered.

מרחב, "from a breadth" — רחב (probably masc.) means "breath, width"; cf. הִתְבַּנְּנָה עַד רַחְבִּי אֶרֶץ, "Have you comprehended up to the breadth of the earth?" (Job 38:18).

מרחב, "from (the) breadth/width," where רחב (prob. masc.) means "breath, width"; cf. וְרַחְבִּי הַבַּיִת, "and the width of the front of the temple" (Ezek. 41:14).

מרחב, "from (the) open/public place," where רחוב (double gender) means "open/public place"; e.g., אֲשֶׁר גָּנְבוּ אֶתָם מִרְחֹב בֵּית שָׁן, "which they stole from the public place of Beth-shan" (2 Sam. 21:12).

מרחב (probably masc.) means "wide place"; e.g., וַיִּצְיֹאֲנִי לְמִרְחָב, "and He

16 The suggestion of Allegro^{Pr} resembles the Targum ביצוהי ופצירוהי לא יתסון למחפורין, "Its miry places and its marshes shall not be healed, for they shall be salt pits. And by the river shall grow tree upon its banks from here and from there" (Trg. Ezek. 47:11-12).

17 Allegro, 49, 158 n. 216; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

18 Milik, 294-95, 255 C-177; Milik^E, 141-42.

19 BY 3, 2410a-11a; ESh^{dic} 3, 1066a.

20 Lurie, 109-10 and nn. 3, 5.

21 Pixner, 353.

22 Wolters, 48-49.

23 Garcia Martinez, 462.

24 Beyer, 230-31.

25 Vermes, 376.

26 Wise, 196.

led me out to a wide place" (Ps. 18:20; cf. Pixner).²⁷

Regarding **לפיהם**, the drawings differ. ALLEGRO's has a horizontal line at the bottom of the word connecting the letters *yod* and *he*. This with a slight difference also can be seen in the drawings of BAKER and MILIK. The *yod* may be a *nun*, i.e., **לפנהם**, or it is a ligature of a *waw/yod* and a *nun*, i.e., **לפונהם** - **לפינהם**. In addition, the *he* can be read as a *het* or *taw*.

For this difficult word and/or phrase the following readings, vocalizations, and interpretations are offered. In some the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*;²⁸ cf. **כְּפָרִין** for **כִּפְרִין** = **כְּפֹרִים** (see #47, 10:11). It should be noted that "their" refers to **מֵיִם**, "waters," which is rendered as "its."

לְפִיהֶם = **לְפִיהֶם**, "in/at their (masc.) mouth" (cf. Allegro^{pr}, Allegro^{rev}), must refer to **מֵיִם**, "waters" (pl. masc.); i.e., "in the water's mouth." Since the prepositions **לְ**, **עַל**, **אֶל**, and even **בְּ** are often interchanged, **לְפִיהֶם** = **עַל פִּיהֶם** = **בְּפִיהֶם** = **אֶל פִּיהֶם** mean, "upon/in/at/by/to their opening." E.g., **וְכָף**, **וְשִׁמוּ לְפִיהֶם**, "and they placed a hand upon their mouth" (Job 29:9), vs. **עַל פִּי**, **יִשְׁמֹו יָד עַל פִּה**, "they placed a hand upon (the) mouth" (Micha 7:16); **אֶל פִּי הַמַּעְרָה** vs. **הַמַּעְרָה** (Josh. 10:27 and 10:18, respectively). Regarding the interchange of the prepositions *bet-lamed*, see #1, 1:1; #20, 4:13; #37, 8:14.

לְפִנֵּיהֶם or **לְפִנֵּיהֶם** = **לְפִנֵּיהֶם**, "in front of them (masc.)," i.e., in front of the waters (cf. Wolters, Beyer); cf. **וְהָאֶרֶץ הַגְּדֹלָה רַחֲבַת יָדַיִם לְפִנֵּיהֶם**, "and the land, behold, it is large in front of them" (Gen. 34:21); **וְאֵילָמוּ לְפִנֵּיהֶם**, "and their halls (being) in front of them" (Ezek. 40:22,26).

לְפִנֵּיהֶם or **לְפִנֵּיהֶם** = **לְפִנֵּיהֶם** = **עַל פְּנוֹתָם**, "for/to/at their corners," i.e., at/-the corners of **מֵיִם**, **קִילָח מֵיִם**, "the water jet"; cf. **וְנִשְׁמֹו פְּנוֹתֵם הַחֲרֵבָתִי חוּצוֹתֵם**, "their corner towers became desolated, I have destroyed their streets" (Zeph. 3:6); **וְלֹא יִקְחוּ מִמֶּךָ אֲבֵן לְפִנָּה וְאֲבֵן לְמוֹסְדוֹת**, "and they shall not take from you a stone for a corner, and a stone for a foundations" (Jer. 51:26); **עַל פִּנֵּת**, **גִּגַּ**, "upon a corner of the roof" (Prov. 21:9, 25:24); also, **פִּנֵּתָהּ**, "its (fem.) corner" (Job 38:6); **פְּנוֹתָיו**, "its (masc.) corners" (Exod. 27:2); etc. Regarding **פִּנָּה**, see #12, 3:1-2.

מֵרָחֵב עַל פִּיהֶם = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם** = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם**, "from (the) width upon/along their mouths/openings."

מֵרָחֵב עַל פִּיהֶם = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם** = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם**, "from (the) width upon/along their mouths/openings."

מֵרָחֵב עַל פִּיהֶם = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם** = **מֵרָחֵב לְפִיהֶם**, "from the open place upon their openings."

²⁷ **מֵרָחֵב** cannot be a verbal formation, such as **מֵרָחֵב** (*Hif'il* pres. part. masc. sg.), "to enlarge"; e.g., **בְּרוּךְ הוּא מֵרָחֵב גֹּד**, "Blessed be He who enlarges Gad" (Deut. 33:20). Since **מֵרָחֵב** is followed by **לְפִיהֶם** - **לְפִנֵּיהֶם**, with a plural third person suffix referring to **מֵיִם** (pl.), the adjective **רָחֵב** (adj., masc.), "wide, broad" (e.g., Job 30:14), without a plural suffix is not relevant. Therefore, **מֵרָחֵב** must be a noun meaning "wide space" or "width."

מֶרֶחַב עַל פִּיהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִיהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִיהֶם, “(there is) an open area at/to/along their openings.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם, “from the width toward their front.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם, “from the width toward their front.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם, “from an open area to their front.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפָנֵיהֶם, “(there is) a open area in/by their front.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם, “from the width to their corners.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם, “from the width to their corners.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם, “from the open area to their corners.”

מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם or מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם = מֶרֶחַב לְפִנְיָהֶם, “(there is) a open area in/by their corners.”

Finally, the second and third letter of מֶרֶחַב can be read as *dalet* and *he*, i.e., מֶדֶהָב = מֶן דֶּהָב, an Aramaism, same as מֶזֶהָב = מֶן זָהָב, “from/of gold.” מֶדֶהָב לְפִיהֶם = מֶדֶהָב לְפִיהֶם means “of gold upon/at/by their openings.” מֶדֶהָב may indicate that this cache consists of 9 karsh gold. If מֶדֶהָב is connected with the previous word, i.e., הַבֵּיב מֶדֶהָב, “the drain (is) of gold” or “the Golden Drain,” then it may refer to its name or color.²⁸ Regarding alternate Aramaism in the Scroll, see #55, 11:14; Appendix D.

(9:12-13) חֲפֹרֵי חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת שֶׁבַע כֹּחַ 9, “(there) are buried seven cubits (deep) 9 s(ilver) k(arsh),” or “dig seven cubits (deep, there are) 9 s(ilver) k(arsh)” — Regarding חֲפֹר, see #17, 4:7; אֲמוֹת, #1, 1:2-3; for כֹּחַ, Appendix A.

28 It is possible to vocalize מֶדֶהָב as מֶדֶהָב (prob. masc.); cf. מֶדֶהָבָה (prob. fem., Isa. 14:4), “exactress of gold” (JPSⁱ), “oppression” (JPSⁱⁱ), “golden city” (Koren); “arrogance” (*Tanach*, cf. Rashi), etc. Radak says that מֶדֶהָבָה is from דֶּהָב, “gold,” and it refers to Babylon, the owner of the gold collected as taxes from all the lands (cf. *Mešudat Zion*, *Mešudat David*, Malbim). Also, מֶדֶהָבָה, מִלְכּוֹת שֶׁהֵיא מֶדֶהָבָת פָּנָיו שֶׁל אָדָם, “Madhevah is a kingdom that makes glowing the faces of the man” (where “glowing” is a euphemism for “gloomings”; Lev. Rabbah 15). Accordingly, מֶדֶהָבָה = מֶדֶהָבָה = דֶּהָבָה plus a locative *mem*, i.e., “place of gold.” מֶדֶהָב appears in a Dead Sea document, וְאַל תִּשְׁקוֹד מִמֶּדֶהָבָה (4Q416 f2 ii:14); cf. Wacholder (4, 225b), who translates מֶדֶהָב as “gold (?)” Eisenman and Wise render this phrase as, “and do not stay awake at night because of your money” (R. Eisenman and M. Wise, *Dead Sea Scrolls Uncovered*, 253). מֶדֶהָב also occurs in 1QH 3:25, 12:18. However, in 1QIS^a it is written מֶדֶהָבָה, with a *reš* (LLBIS, 197). Similarly, BDB (923b) suggests the reading of מֶדֶהָבָה in Isaiah, and renders it as “boisterous, raging, behaviour.”

ITEM 43

בשית שיבצפון פי הצוק של בית	9:14
תמר בצחיאת גר פלע	9:15
כל שבה חרמ	9:16

- 9:14 In the deep pit which is at the northern edge of the peak of Beth
- 9:15 Tamar, in the parched area of the deep depression of Pela^c,
- 9:16 everything in it is consecrated.

COMMENTARY

(9:14-15) בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שִׁיבְצָפֹן פִּי הַצֹּק שֶׁל בֵּית תְּמָר־תְּמָרִימָר “In a/the deep pit which is in/at/by (the) northern edge of the peak of Beth Tamar (or House of [the] Palm, house of [the] palm-like figure/column” — ALLEGRO¹: “In the Shith (foundation), turn to the North, face a pinnacle of the House of Tamar” (i.e., בשית שוב צפון פן הצוק של בית תמר, “base or foundation”; also *Shith* of the Temple, a pit by the side of the altar into which the remainder of the libation were poured; cf. 12:10. פנה for פן, “face!”¹ The other scholars essentially read this phrase as presented above.²

בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית, “in/at/by a/the deep pit,” can also be read as בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית or בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית, “in/at/by a/the pit,” as elsewhere in the Scroll (see #13, 3:8).

שִׁיבְצָפֹן is a phonetic spelling for שְׁבָצָפֹן, the construct of שֶׁל = שְׁבָצָפֹן שֶׁל, “which is in/at/by (the) north of (see #19, 4:11); cf. שִׁיבִית for שְׁבִית = שְׁבִית שֶׁל, “in the house of” (see #46, 10:5). Regarding geographical directions, see #10, 2:10.

פִּי הַצֹּק, the construct of פֶּה שֶׁל הַצֹּק, literally “mouth of the peak,” could mean “edge of the peak,” or “along the peak” (see #35, 8:8).

This phrase can also be read as פֶּה שֶׁל צֹק (= פֶּה שֶׁל צֹק), construct of פֶּה שֶׁל צֹק,

1 The reading of שִׁיבְצָפֹן is based on the translation. Allegro’s notes were first typed and then corrected. It is possible that originally Allegro wrote “פנה for פן” or “פנה or פן.”

2 Beyer (230) reads שובצפון and שובית (with waws). It should be added that a waw between *sin* and *bet* may represent an original short vowel, especially in some Aramaic dialects. E.g., שְׁבָעָה (MT) and שְׁבָעָה (TO) vs. שְׁבָעָה (PsJ, TN), “seven” (Gen. 7:2); שְׁבָעִים (MT) and שְׁבָעִין (TO) vs. שְׁבָעִין (PsJ, TN), “seventy” (Gen. 5:12); הַשְּׁבָלִים (MT) and שְׁבָלִיא (TO) vs. שְׁבָלִיא (PsJ, TN), “the ears of grain” (Gen. Ch. 41); הַשְּׁבֶת (MT) and שְׁבָתָא (PsJ) vs. שְׁבָתָא (TN), “the Sabbath” (Exod. 16:29).

"corner (tower) of a/(the) peak" (the *waw* may be a short-legged final *nun* in middle position, while *he* and *taw* are often indistinguishable); cf. מִתַּחַת פֶּתַח (=), "Below the southern corner of the ossuary" (see 51, 11:2). Accordingly, צוֹק (= פֶּתַח) (= שְׁבָצָפוֹן) (= שְׁבָצָפוֹן) may mean, "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in/at/by the north of (the) corner (tower) of a/(the) peak." Regarding פֶּתַח, see #12, 3:1.

בֵּית תָּמָר has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO³: "the House of Tamar"; תָּמָר was Absalom's sister; cf. 10:12 (i.e., "Memorial of Absalom") and 1QpHab. v. 9. ALLEGRO: "Place of the Palm," Beththamar of the Onomasticon of Eusebius for Baal-tamar near Gibeah; or Pasaelis (of Herod) at the mouth of Wady Ifjim; or Archelais (built by Herod's son as a palm plantation).³ MILIK: Beth-Tamar is Baal-tamar, rather than Kefar Tamrata of Judea, or Kor (Bor ?) Tamrata cited by Klein.⁴ LURIE: Beth-Tamar is near Naaran by Jericho.⁵ PIXNER: Perhaps Beth-Tamar is Kafr Tamer (or Samir) north of Zezun.⁶ BEYER: Bet-Tamar is located 5 km north of Jerusalem.⁷ WISE: Beth Tamar is apparently equivalent of Baal Tamar near Gibeah.⁸

As Allegro mentions that Eusebius (260-339 CE) lists in his *Onomasticon* (56:1-3) Βηθθαμαρ (Beththamar, בֵּית תָּמָר) for the biblical place Baal-Tamar. Steinberg suggests that both בֵּית תָּמָר and בְּעַל תָּמָר of Eusebius are shortened forms of בֵּית תָּמָר; now Hirbat Ras et-Tawil (Ruin of the Large Head), north of Jerusalem.⁹ Regarding בֵּית, see #7, 2:3.

תָּמָר (masc., pl. תָּמָרִים), "palm tree" (e.g., Exod. 15:27; Joel 1:12) is also a personal feminine name, Tamar (daughter-in-law of Judah, Gen. 38:6; daughter of King David, 2 Sam. 13:1; daughter of Absalom, 2 Sam. 14:27), and name of a city in southern Palestine (Ezek. 47:19, 48:28). Also, תָּמָר is a variant of תָּמָר (Judg. 4:5; Jer. 10:5). In addition, תָּמָרָה (fem., pl. תָּמָרוֹת) is a palm-like figure or column (e.g., Ezek. 41:18-20; 1 Kgs 6:35-36). תָּמָר may indicate an unattested masculine singular תָּמָר. Thus, בֵּית תָּמָר can be vocalized as בֵּית תָּמָר and בֵּית תָּמָר, "house of palm," as well as בֵּית תָּמָר, "house of (the) palm-like figure/column."

Scripture names Jericho as יְרֵחוֹ עִיר הַתְּמָרִים, "Jericho City of the Palms" (2 Chron. 28:15).¹⁰ Similarly, the Targum identifies עִיר הַתְּמָרִים with קִרְתָּא

3 Allegro, 158-59 n. 222.

4 Milik, 294-95, 267 D-25; Milik^E, 141, 151; SY, 97, 173.

5 Lurie, 110-11 n. 3.

6 Pixner, 353 n. 37.

7 Beyer, 231.

8 Wise, 196.

9 SB, 114b. Cf. בֵּית מֵעוֹן, Beth-meon (Jer. 48:23), בְּעַל מֵעוֹן, Baal-meon (Ezek. 25:9), בֵּית מֵעוֹן, Beth-baal-meon (Josh. 13:17), also known as בֵּעוֹן, Beon (Num. 32:3) in Reuben; also בעלמען and בית בעלמען in the Mesha Stone. SB, 102a, 115a; *KAI* 1, 33; 2, 174 (#181:9,30); *The Living Torah*, 835, note on Num. 32:3. See also Allegro, 158-59 n. 222; Milik, 267 D-25; Milik^E, 141, 151.

יְרִיחוֹ, “the City of Jericho” (Judg. 1:16, 3:13); בַּעַל תְּמָר, Baal-tamar (“Deity of the Palms”) with מִישְׁרֵי יְרִיחוֹ, “Plain of Jericho” (Judg. 20:33); and תְּמָר, Tamar, with יְרִיחוֹ, Jericho (Judg. 4:5; Jer. 10:5; see #24, 5:13).¹¹

The Talmud mentions אֲנָשֵׁי כְּפַר תְּמַרְתָּא שְׁבִיהוּדָה, “the men of Kefar Temarta’ (A, “Village of the Palms”) which is in Judea” (t. Hul. 3[4]:23; b. Hul. 72a).¹² Since בֵּית (“house of”), בַּעַל (“possessor/deity of”), כְּפַר (“village of”), and עִיר (“city of”), as first element of a compound toponym often are interchangeable, כְּפַר תְּמַרְתָּא, may be the same as בֵּית תְּמָר or בַּעַל תְּמָר. Moreover, the alternate הֵישָׁן, “the old house of the palm(s),” might have been near בֵּית תְּמָר (see #7, 2:3; #55, 11:12). It is questionable whether any of these possibilities can be associated with Jericho.

Although the reading of בֵּית תָּמַר seems to be certain, frequently the Scroll does not distinguish between *bet/mem*, *dalet/reš*, and *he/het/taw*. Consequently, this phrase can be read in many ways, as is shown below.

בֵּית הַבַּד (masc., MH), “house of the olive press” — e.g., קוֹרוֹת בֵּית הַבַּד, “the beams of the olive press” (m. Shab. 1:9).

בֵּית הַבָּד, “house of the (fine) linen” — בָּד (masc., pl. בָּדִים) means “(fine) linen”; e.g., וְלָבַשׁ הַכֹּהֵן מָדוּ בָד וּמִכְנָסֵי בָד יִלְבַּשׁ עַל בְּשָׁרוֹ, “And the priest shall don his fitted linen tunic and he shall don line breeches on his flesh” (Lev. 6:3); בָּד — שִׁיָּהוּ מְבוּן, “‘fine linen’ (Lev. 6:30) — that it shall be from flax” (baraita, b. Zevah. 18b);¹³ also cf. וּמִשְׁפָּחוֹת בֵּית עֲבֹדַת הַבֵּץ לְבֵית אֲשָׁבַע, “and the families of the linen factory of the House of Ashbea,” and its Targum, וּגְנֻסַּת בֵּית עֲבִידַת בּוּצָא דְלְבוּשֵׁי מַלְכֵיָא וְכַהֲנָיָא מְסִירָא לְבֵית אֲשָׁבַע, “and the families of the linen factory for the garments of the kings and priests were given to the House of Ashbea” (1 Chron. 4:21; cf. [Pseudo]-Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*).

בֵּית הַמָּד, “house of the garment” — מָד (masc.) means “(battle) garment”; e.g., וַיַּחְגֹּר דָּוִד אֶת חַרְבּוֹ מֵעַל לְמַדְיוֹ, “And David girded his sword over his

10 Also, בְּקַעַת יְרִיחוֹ עִיר הַתְּמָרִים, “Valley of Jericho the City of the Palms” (Deut. 34:3); and its Targumim: בְּקַעַתָּא יְרִיחוֹ קְרַתָּא דְּקַלְיָא, “Valley of Jericho, City of the Palms” (TO); בְּקַעַת דִּירִיחוֹ קְרַתָּא דְּעִבְדָּא תְּמָרִין, “the Valley of Jericho, palm producing city” (Frag.); בְּקַעַתָּא דִּירִיחוֹ ... קְרוֹת דְּקַלְיָא, “the Valley of Jericho ... the City of the Palms” (PsJ). בְּבִקְעָתִיה דִּירִיחוֹ קְרַתָּא דְּעִבְדָּא תְּמָרִין, “in its Valley of Jericho, palm producing city” (TN).

11 Also, עֵין גְּדִי, En-ge-di by the Dead Sea was known earlier as חַצְצוֹן תְּמָר, Hazazon-tamar (2 Chron. 20:2; TO and PsJ on Gen. 14:7). Rashi and Radak identify Tamar with Jericho, while *Mešudat David* with Hazazon-tamar (Ezek. 47:19). Once the *ketiv* is תְּמָר, while the *qeri* is תְּדִמֹר, Tadmor (1 Kgs 9:18). See also, Y. Aharoni, “עִיר הַתְּמָרִים” in *EB* 6, 218.

12 Also, רַב שִׁילָא אִישׁ כְּפַר תְּמַרְתָּא, “Rabbi Shila, a native of Kefar Temarta’” (b. Meg. 16a); and his son, רַ' אָחָא בַר שִׁילָא אִישׁ כְּפַר תְּמַרְתָּא, “Rabbi Aha bar Shila, a native of Kefar Temarta’” (Esth. Rabbah 2:14).

13 Kohut connects בָּד, בּוּץ, and the Arabic *bas*, and renders as *Weisslinnen* (“white linen”; *AC* 2, 14). Accordingly, it is a *dalet-šade* letter interchange; cf. the root family דֹּהַב - זָהָב which has to do with gleaming or gold.

battle garment" (1 Sam. 17:39), also see the previous paragraph.

בֵּית הַמֶּדָּה, "the spacious house" — מֶדָּה is a masculine form of מִדָּה (fem.), "measure"; אֶרְכָּהּ מֵאֶרֶץ מִדָּה, "it is longer than the earth its (fem.) measure" (Job 11:9); e.g., בֵּית מְדוֹת, "a large house" (Jer. 22:14); cf. בֵּית הַמִּדָּה הַיֵּשָׁן (see #7, 2:3, alt.).

בֵּית הַמֶּר or בֵּית הָמֶר, "the bitter house" — מֶר (masc. adj., pausal מָר, pl. מָרִים, pl. const. מָרִי, sg. fem. מֶרָה), "bitter"; cf. מֵי הַמָּרִים הַמְאָרְרִים, "the bitter afflicting waters" (Num. 5:18-19); דְּבַר מֶר, "a bitter thing" (Ps. 64:4); יֵרֶק מֶר, "bitter herb" (b. Pes. 39a); בֵּית חֲדָשׁ, "a new house" (Deut. 20:5, 22:8); בֵּית נֶאֱמָן, "a faithful house" (1 Sam. 2:35, 25:28); also בֵּית הַמֶּרָה בֵּית הַיֵּשָׁן (see #7, 2:3, alt.).

בֵּית הַמֶּר or בֵּית הָמֶר, "house of the master" — מֶר or מָר (MH, JA) means master, lord, teacher"; cf. וְלָמָּה נִקְרָא אֲמֶרְכָל מִפְּנֵי שְׁמֵר עַל הַכֹּל, "And why he is called 'amarkol? Because he is a lord above everything" (t. Sheq. 2:15); also cf. וּמֶרָא מַלְכִּין, "and Lord of the Kings" (Dan. 2:47, BA).

בֵּית הַמֶּר or בֵּית הָמֶר, "house of the hoe" — מֶר or מָר (TH) and מָרָא (JA) mean "hoe"; e.g., חוּץ מִמֶּר פֶּסֶל וְקִרְדּוֹם, "except of hoe, adze, and axe" (b. Ber. 57b).¹⁴

בֵּית הַמֶּר, "house of the myrrh" — מוֹר, "myrrh" was used making incense; cf. הַר הַמּוֹר, "Mountain of the Myrrh" (Songs 4:6); it is also used in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. Miq. 9:5; t. Miq. 6 [7]:16).

בֵּית חֶבֶר, "House of Heber" — cf. בֵּית חֶבֶר הַקִּינִי, "the House of Heber the Kenite" (Judg. 4:17).

בֵּית חֶבֶר, "House of association/community" — cf. בֵּית חֶבֶר (Prov. 21:9, 25:24); also בֵּית חֶבְרָה הַיֵּשָׁן (see #7, 2:3, alt.).

בֵּית חֶמֶד, "house of delight" — cf. שְׂדֵי חֶמֶד, "pleasant fields" (Isa. 32:12); כִּרְמֵי חֶמֶד, "pleasant vineyards" (Amos 5:11); cf. בֵּית חֶמְדָּה הַיֵּשָׁן (2:3).

בֵּית חֶמֶר, "House of Wine" — cf. כִּרְם חֶמֶר, "vineyard" (Isa. 27:2), בֵּית הַכֶּרֶם, Beth-cherem or "House of the Vineyard" (Jer. 6:1; Neh. 3:14; also in the Scroll; see #46, 10:5).

בֵּית חָמֹר, "House of Hamor" — cf. חָמֹר אָבִי שָׁכֶם, "Hamor the father of Shechem" (Gen. 33:19).

בֵּית חֲמֹר, "house of donkey" — cf. קְבוּרַת חֲמֹר יִקְבֹּר, "a donkey grave shall he (i.e., King Jehoiakim) be buried" (Jer. 22:19), i.e., left unburied (see Targum, Rashi, Radak, *Mešudat David*).

בֵּית חֲמֶר, "house of clay" — cf. בָּתֵּי חֲמֶר, "houses of clay" (Job 4:19), referring to graves (see Targum, Rashi).

בֵּית חָמָר, "house of asphalt" — cf. בְּאֵרֹת בָּאֵרֹת חָמָר, "many asphalt pits" (Gen. 14:10); cf. בֵּית חֲמֵרֹת הַיֵּשָׁן (see #7, 2:3, alt.).

¹⁴ Rashi renders מֶר in Old-French as פֹּרְשִׁיר, *fos(s)oir*, "hoe," and פֶּסֶל as דִּילִירִיר or דִּוִּלִירִיר, *doloire* (French *doloire*), "adze" (see Catane, 5a; Gukovitzki, 40, 80). Kohut derives מֶר from μάρ'ον (AC 5, 235b).

בֵּית תָּבוֹר, Beth Tabor — cf. תָּבוֹר, Tabor, a Levitical city in Zebulun (1 Chron. 6:62),¹⁵ and הַר תָּבוֹר, Mount Tabor (Judg. 4:6); also בֵּית תְּבֵרֵהָת (see #7, 2:3, alt.).

Finally, בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שִׁבְצָפוֹן פִּי הַצּוֹק שֶׁל בֵּית תָּמָר resembles the phrases: בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית הַמְּזֻרְחִית שֶׁבְצָפוֹן (= שִׁבְצָפוֹן) בְּחֶלֶת which is in/at/by (the) north of Kahelet” (see #19, 4:11-12); and בִּיגְרוֹיִגְרָ שֶׁל פִּי צוֹק הַקִּדְרוֹן “In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by (the) edge of the peak of Kidron” (see #35, 8:8).

(9:15) גְּרוֹגֵד פֶּלַע (= בְּצִחִיָּא = “in a/the parched area of (the) deep depression of Pela^c (or Gad Pela^c, etc.)” — ALLEGRO^{PF}: “in the dry dust (?) thou shall scrape a passage” (i.e., בְּצִחִיָּא תִגְרַפְּ לַע, “be dry,” so “dry dust”; cf. צִחִיָּא (A), “dryness.” לַע, “throat (BH), jaw, cheek (MH).”¹⁶ ALLEGRO: the text has בְּצִחִיָּא גֵד פֶּלַע, but read גֵּד פֶּלַע, “at the outlet of the Valley of PL^c.” There may be confusion between *het/taw* and *dalet*. The scribe realizing his error wrote a *yod* next to it, thus בְּצִיָּא is defective of בְּצִחִיָּא, cf. 8:14. In גֵּד the *dalet* is confused for *yod*, as is commonly found in the text.¹⁷ MILIK: בְּצִחִיָּא גֵר פֶּלַע, “in the parched area (near) the bushy Cairn”; צִחִיָּא or צִהִיָּא, “parched area”; גֵּר פֶּלַע is like גֵּל פֶּרַע, “the bushy cairn.”¹⁸ LURIE: בְּצִהִיָּא גֵי פֶלַע, “at the place where the river Pela^c exits (from between the mountains)”; בְּצִהִיָּא is a variant of בְּצִחִיָּא; גֵּי פֶלַע is an unknown rivulet.¹⁹ PIXNER (reads as Milik): “in the barren land of the Proselyte Phala”; the second word is גֵּר; the proper name of Phala (Φαλαδύς) of the tribe of Reuben is mentioned by Josephus (Ant. iv, 2, 2, par. 19); or a man from Pella, ‘ayin instead of ^lalef or he, as suggested by Puech.²⁰ WOLTERS: בְּצִחִיָּא גֵר פֶּלַע, “in the arid region of Garpela.”²¹ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “in the rocky ground of Ger Pela”²² BEYER (reads as Milik): “on the glitter hot spot of the limestone of Pal^c (the split in Arabic).”²³ VERMES: “in the parched land of ... (?).”²⁴ WILMOT:

15 Similar names are: תָּבוֹר, הַר תָּבוֹר, Mount Tabor (Judg. 4:6) near the border of Naphtali; אֲזֹנוֹת תָּבוֹר, Aznoth-tabor (Josh. 19:34) in Naphtali; אֵלֹן תָּבוֹר, Elon-tabor or Terebinth of Tabor (1 Sam. 10:3), near Rachel’s Tomb; and כִּסְלֹת תָּבוֹר, Chisloth-tabor (Josh. 19:12) in Issachar.

16 The assumed reading תִּגְרַפְּ (= תִּגְרַף) is based on the translation. גִּרָף (MH, JA) means “to scrape, sweep” (cf. Jastrow 272a).

17 Allegro, 49, 143 n. 84, 156 n. 182, 159-60 n. 223; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

18 Milik, 294-95, 229 B-11b, 240 C-26, 242 C-49, 247 C-90; Milik^E, 141.

19 Lurie, 110-13 and nn. 4-5.

20 Pixner, 353 and n. 37.

21 Wolters, 48-49.

22 Garcia Martinez, 462-63.

23 Beyer, 230-31.

24 Vermes, 377.

פלע.²⁵ Wise: "at the outlet of the Pele Ravine."²⁶

The phrase *בצחית גדיגר פלע* consists of eleven letters that are relatively easy to identify (although some of them can be read in more than one way), making three unusual words. It is similar to the equally difficult phrase *בבור* *בבור מוקות* (see #45, 10:3). The following are some suggestions.

בצחית = *בצחית* (cf. Milik), "in (the) dry land of (or which is in)," is a phonetic spelling like *לאח* = *לח* (see #55, 11:14). *צחית* is the assumed construct state of the unattested *צחיה* (fem.), "dry land";²⁷ cf. *צחה צמא*, "parched with thirst" (Isa. 5:13), and the Aramaic *צחיתא* (בית), "parched area" (PsJ and Frag. Deut. 32:10), both from the root *צחא*, "to be thirsty." The vocalization can be compared to *צבי*, "male gazelle" (e.g., Deut. 12:15) and *צביה*, "female gazelle" (Songs 4:5, 7:4); *בכי* (masc.), "cry, lament"; e.g., *ויבכו בכי גדול*, "and they wept (in) a loud cry" (Judg. 21:2); and *בכיה* (fem.), "cry, lament"; e.g., *ובכתה בכיה גדולה*, "and she wept (in) a loud cry" (b. Nid. 52a). The assumed singular constructs forms are *בכית* and *צבית*.²⁸ Also, *בצחיתא* ... *בשיתובשית* is like the phrase *בשיתובשית* *שבצח* *א/ב/א/ה* "In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) dry land" (see #60, 12:10, alt.), where *צח* = *צחי* (cf. *כלכל* for *כלילכלי*, see #58, 12:6; #59, 12:8), may be a masculine form of *צחיה* (fem.).

בצחיתא = *בצחיתא*, "in (the) dry land of" (with a *het*; const.), is a phonetic spelling. *צחית* (masc.) means "bare"; e.g., *לצחית סלע*, "for a bare rock" (Ezek. 26:4); *צחיתה* (fem.) and its Targum *צחיתין*, "bare, dry (land)" (Ps. 68:7); *והשביע בצחיות נפשו*, "and He will satisfy your soul (even) in parched places" (reduplicated, fem. pl.; Isa. 58:11). The roots *צחח*, "to glow," and *צחה* are related. *בצחיתא* ... *בשיתובשית* is similar to *בשיתובשית* *שבצח* *א/ב/א/ה*, where *צח* may be a variant of *צחיה* (see #60, 12:10, alt.).

בצחיתא for *בצחיתא* = *בצחיתא*, "in (the) catacomb/tower of," the first *het* may be a scribal error for a *reš*, and phonetic spelling (see #8, 2:5). This suggestion is supported by the phrase *בבור גדיגר מוקות*, "in the cistern of ... of the canals" (see #45, 10:3). *בצחיתא* ... *בשיתובשית* is like the amended *בשיתובשית* *שבצח* *א/ב/א/ה*, "in/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) catacomb/tower" (see #60, 12:10, alt.).

The next word, which appears again (10:3), can be read as *גד* (with *dalet*), *גר* (with *reš*), and *גו* or *גי* (the *reš* shaped letter is a long-headed *waw/yod*). This term seems to be in the construct state. Some of the following interpretations are applicable only in one of the two cases, while others for both.

גד (H, A), "Gad, luck, fortune," is the name of one of Jacob's sons, "And Leah said *גד* *בא* (*qeri*, Fortune has arrived) and she called his name *גד*

25 "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," 20.

26 Wise, 196.

27 Cf. the Modern Hebrew *צחי* (masc.) and *צחיה* (fem.), "dry, ruin" (ESh^{dic} 5, 2216b).

28 E.g., ESh^{dic} 1, 231a; 5, 2195b.

(Gad/Fortune)" (Gen. 30:11). He was the ancestor of the Tribe of Gad (e.g., Num. 2:14) that lived in אֶרֶץ גָּד, in the "Land of Gad" (1 Sam. 13:7). The tribe Gad is also mentioned in the Mesha Inscription (line 10). מִגְדַּל גָּד, Migdal Gad (Tower of Gad/Fortune), in a place in Judah (Josh. 15:37). גָּד הַנְּבִיא, Gad the prophet of King David (1 Sam. 22:5; 1 Chron. 29:29; etc.). גָּד, Fortune, is a deity. הַעֲרֹכִים לְגָד שֶׁלֶחֶן, "who are setting for Gad/Fortune a table" (Isa. 65:11). עַל גָּד בְּבִקְעַת הַלְבָּנוֹן תַּחַת הַר חֶרְמוֹן, "Baal-gad (Possessor of Fortune) in the Valley of Lebanon under Mount Hermon" (Josh. 11:17) was a sacred site for Fortune.²⁹ יוֹן גָּד, "Greek Fortune" (a deity), is a toponym in the vicinity of Jerusalem; e.g., יוֹן לְשִׁילֹחַ, "like (the time walking) from Gad Yawan to Shiloah" (m. Zav. 1:5).³⁰ In addition, גָּד (masc.) is a certain plant, perhaps "coriander" (Exod. 16:31; Num. 11:7). Moreover, חֲצֵר גָּדָה, Hazar Gaddah or "Court of Gaddah," is a toponym in southern Judah (Josh. 15:27). גָּדָה may be a feminine formation of גָּד. Also, גוּדָא, Gudda, is a masculine personal name (b. 'A.Z. 32a).

גָּד (abs., גָּד, const.) may be an unattested masculine form of גָּדָה (fem.), "wall, riverbank" (from the root גָּדָה, "to cut"); e.g., וַהֲיִדְדֵן מְלֵא עַל כָּל, "and the Jordan was filled on all its banks" (Josh. 3:15). Regarding the vocalization, cf. דָּג (masc. abs., דָּג, const.) vs. דָּגָה (fem.), "fish" (Jonah 2:1 and 2:1, respectively). גוּדָא is the Aramaic of גָּדָה, "the wall, riverbank"; e.g., גוּדָא דְעֵלְמָא, "the wall of the world" (Trg. Eccl. 10:8). גוּדָא may be masculine, if so the absolute is גוּד or גוּדָה.³¹

גָּר may mean "spring (of)"; cf. the difficult verse, פָּרֵץ נָחַל מֵעַם גָּר, "He breaks away the river from the spring" (Job 28:4). The Targum explains גָּר as אֲתָרָא דִּי מְזַלְח מְרֻבְּנֵי, "the place which is gushing of gutters,"³² i.e., "springs." Rashi derives גָּר from the root נָגַר, "to pour, flow, run."³³ גָּר

29 See SB, 114a; Y. Aharoni, "Baal-Gad," *EJ* 4, 3. Also cf. the name אַבְרִגַּד or אַבְרִגַּד, Abirgad, i.e., "Gad is mighty," in a Phoenician votive seal; see N. Avigad, "Two Phoenician Votive Seals," *IEJ* 26 (1966), 243-47.

30 Also, כְּמִגְדִּיּוֹן לְשִׁילָה, "like from Gadion to Shilo" (t. Zav. 1:10; b. San. 63b), where גִּדִּיּוֹן is a contracted form of יוֹן גָּד, while שִׁילָה is a variant of שִׁילֹחַ, where the *het* became silent, rather than שִׁילָה (Shilo, Josh. 18:1). See Rashi on this Gemara; Bertinoro and *Tif'eret Israel* on the Mishnah; *Mele'khet Šelomoh* vocalizes as יוֹן גָּד, Gad Yon, and that the distance between these two places is one hundred cubits. Jastrow (210a) notes that Gad Yawan may be a pool connected with Shiloah, perhaps the "Fount of the Virgin." According to Reich, that יוֹן גָּד may be an error for גָּדוֹן, the *het* separated into a *dalet* and a *yod* (R. Reich, "כֶּמֶן גַּר יוֹן לְשִׁלָּח", לתולדותיו של מעיין הגיחון בימי הבית השני", in *IEJ* 19 [1987], 330-33, 83*^b). Cf. אֲרוֹחַ אַחַת, the *reš* and the *waw* are parts of a *het* (see #1, 1:3; #32, 7:14).

31 Some consider גוּדָא as masculine (e.g., Karo, 37b), while others as feminine (Jastrow, 218a; KS 1, 146). See also *AC* 2, 238a-39a.

32 Cf. Jastrow, 401b.

33 Also see the comments of Rik on this verse, and that of Ch.B. Chavel in *A Commentary on the Book of Job by Rabbeynu Meyuchos ben Eliyahu* (1969), 68 n. 5.

(prob. masc.) is the pausal form of גֵּר (abs. and const.); cf. פֶּר (masc., abs.), "ox" (e.g., Exod. 29:1), פָּר (pausal; e.g., Num. 23:4), פֶּר (const.), "ox of" (e.g., Lev. 8:2); שֵׁר (masc. abs.), "prince" (e.g., Exod. 2:14), שָׁר (pausal; e.g., Hosea 3:4), שֵׁר (const.), "prince of" (e.g., Gen. 40:22).

גֵּר may mean "deep depression (of)," or perhaps "ruin (of)." Ben-Yehuda connects גֵּר with the Arabic *ġar*, "deep depression" in the ground. Thus, פָּרַץ גֵּר נָחַל מַעַם גֵּר would mean, "He breaks away a/(the) river from a/(the) deep depression."³⁴ Cf. בִּתְבֻסַּת רֹאשׁ הַסֵּלַע, "in/at/by a/the grave/ruin/depression of the top of the rock" (see #52, 11:5).

גֵּר = גִּיר (defective, masc., גִּירָא, BA), "chalk, plaster (of)"; כָּאֲבִנֵי גִיר and its Targum, כָּאֲבִנֵי גִיר מִנְפָצִין, "like crushed chalk stones" (Isa. 27:9); and עַל גִּירָא דִּי כְתֵל הַיְכָלָא דִּי מַלְכָא, "on the plaster of the wall of the royal palace" (BA, Dan. 5:5). גִּירָא is a synonym of שֵׁיד - סִיד, "chalk."³⁵

גֵּר could be defective spelling of גֹּר, "Gur (of)"; it will be further discussed later.

גֵּר may be a variant of יְגֵרִיגְרִיגֹר, "Yegar, Yeger, Jagur, (stone) heap, grave site, altar (of)." The latter appears thrice in the Scroll (see #20, 4:13).

גֵּר could be a variant of גֵּן (masc.), "garden," a *reš-nun* interchange (cf. חפון - עכור - עכון, חפור - חפון; see #17, 4:7). The feminine גֵּנָה - גֵּנָה occurs in גֵּנַת צָדוֹק, "(Burial) Garden of Zadok" (see #52, 11:6).

גֵּר may be a variant of גַּל (masc.; cf. Milik), "heap, grave site, well, wave, door hinge (of)," a *lamed-reš* interchange (see #4, 1:11).

גֵּר for גו, the *reš* may be a long-headed *waw*, or an error for a *waw*; cf. שְׁבִשְׁרִילִי for שְׁבִשְׁרִילִי, מְשֻׁלֹּי for מְשֻׁלֹּי; see #38, 9:1), and רִמְחָצָא for רִמְחָצָא; see 39, 9:6). גו has at least two meanings.

גו (masc.) means "back, body (of)" (Prov. 10:13), also גִּוָּה (fem., Job 20:25), and גִּוִּיָּה (fem.), "body, corpse" (1 Sam. 31:12). גו is related to גֵּב (BH, BA), "back, elevation," and גִּבּוּהַ, "height, elevation," (cf. 1:14).³⁶

גו (masc.) means "midst, middle (of)" (Job 30:5). גו - גו is commonly used in the Talmud (e.g., b. B.Q. 44b), and may well be an Aramaism. The Aramaic form is גּוּא (e.g., Dan. 3:24-26).³⁷

פִּלְע, the next word, is also problematic. It seems to be a noun (common, personal name, toponym) or an adjective, rather than a verbal form. There is no known Hebrew or Aramaic root of פִּלְע, but it does exist in Arabic. The verbal forms *fala*^c (פִּלְע) and *falla*^c (פִּלְע) mean "to split, cut," and the nominal *fil*^c (פִּלְע), "fissure, crack."

³⁴ BY 2, 830a and n. 2.

³⁵ See Radak and *Mešudat Zion* on the former, and Rashi, Sa'adiah Ga'on, Ibn-Ezra, and *Mešudat Zion* and on the latter verse.

³⁶ גו and גֵּב are related to גֵּר (Exod. 21:3), גִּוָּה (MH), גִּוָּהַ (BH), "body, corpse," *waw-bet*, *bet-pe*, or *waw-pe* interchanges (cf. SB, 153b). See J. Kafah's note in *Perušeī Rabbeinu Sa'adiah Ga'on 'al haTorah* on Exod. 21:3, p. 85 n. 4.

³⁷ Some claim that גּוּ could mean "community" (cf. BY 2, 714b and nn. 2-3).

פָּלַע (masc., pl. פְּלָעִים) — Cf. סָלַע (masc.), “rock” (e.g., Judg. 6:20), Sela or Petra (a toponym, e.g., Judg. 1:36), סִלְעִים (pl., Isa. 33:16), from the root סלע, “to cleave, split” in Arabic (see #10, 2:11; #52, 11:5); צָלַע (masc.), “stumbling, calamity” (e.g., Ps. 38:18), from the root צלעⁱⁱ, “to limp” (סָלַע in Aramaic, *ṣet-šade* interchange); קָלַע (masc.), “sling” (e.g., Zech. 9:15; pl. קָלָעִים, 2 Chron. 26:14), from the root קלע, “to sling” (e.g., Judg. 20:16); קָלַע (masc.), “curtain” (e.g., t. B.Q. 8:17), pl. קָלָעִים (e.g., Exod. 27:9), from the root קלעⁱⁱ, “to carve” (e.g., 1 Kgs 6:29). Also can be compared with the personal name and toponym בִּלַּע, Bela, from the root בלע, “to swallow, engulf.” This word will be discussed later.

פָּלַע (masc., pl. פִּלְעִים) – Cf. בָּלַע, “swallower” (e.g., Num. Rabbah 14); קָלַע, “slinger,” the assumed singular of קָלְעִים (2 Kgs 3:25); also אָדָר, Ad-dar, a personal name (1 Chron. 8:3), and חָצֵר אָדָר, Hazar-addar, a city in southern Palestine (Num. 34:4).

Also cf. the personal name פִּלְעִי, *Pil'ei*, (e.g., Gen. 22:21). פִּלְעִי, פִּלְעִי, פִּלְעִי, or פִּלְעִי may mean “fissure, crack,” an equivalent of the above mentioned Arabic noun *fil'* (פִּלְעִי). If so, the Copper Scroll may reveal an otherwise unknown Hebrew word (and root). פִּלְעִי, a synonym of this suggestion, occurs earlier in the Scroll, פִּלְעִי שֶׁבְּסַכָּח־אֶשְׁכַּח־בְּפִלְעִי, “In/at/by a/the fissure which is in (the) Sacakah” (see #22, 5:5).

38 See BDB, 1068a-69b. The feminine forms are תולעָה (Isa. 14:11; Job 25:6) and תולעת (e.g., Isa. 41:14); the denominals are תלעַ (Pi'el), "to remove worms" (e.g., y. Sabb. 7:2 [27b]); תלעַ (Pu'al), "to clad in scarlet" (Nah. 2:4); "to become wormy" (e.g., m. B.B. 6:2); התליעַ (Hif'il), "to decay" (e.g., m. Kil. 2:3); התלעַ (Hof'al), "infested with worms" (e.g., Songs Rabbah on 6:2).

פרש, פרש, and פרת (from bilateral root פּר; *lamed-reš* interchange); all connote "separating, breaking," etc.³⁹ In addition, often the solution is based on metathesis. The following are some plausible suggestions.

פֶּלֶע, *Pela'*, may be a variant of the Ugaritic personal name *plġn* (פלע'נ).⁴⁰ In Ugaritic, as well as in Hebrew, often *nun* is added at the end of a name.⁴¹ Thus, *plġn* is the same as *plġ* (פלע'). Since *'ayin* and *gayin* merged in Hebrew into *'ayin*, *plġn* - *plġ* would show up in Hebrew as פֶּלֶע'ן - פֶּלֶע', *Pela'* - *Pal'an*.

פֶּלֶע = בֶּלֶע, *Bela* (*bet-pe* interchange; cf. ספִּין for סבִּין; see #53, 11:8). It will be discussed later.

פֶּלֶע = פֶּלֶא (masc.), "wonder" (e.g., Exod. 15:11), an *'ayin-'alef* interchange.

פֶּלֶע - פֶּלֶע may be related to פֶּלּוּא, *Pallu* the son of Reuben (Gen. 46:9), פִּילָא, *Pila*, father of the Tanna Rabbi Eleazar ben Pila (m. Toḥ. 7:9), and פֶּלְאִיָּה, *Pelaiah* the Levite (Neh. 8:7, 10:11).

פֶּלֶע or פֶּלֶע may be identical with *Pella*, one of the Decapolis, "Ten Cities." This was a league of ten Syrian-Greek cities of the Roman and Byzantine periods in the northern Jordan Valley and in Transjordan.⁴²

פֶּלֶע = פֶּרֶע (masc.), "long hair, leader" (*lamed-reš* interchange); cf. בִּפְרֶע בִּישְׂרָאֵל, "for the loosing of the locks in Israel," or "for the leading of the leaders in Israel" (Judg. 5:2).⁴³ פֶּלֶע = פֶּרֶע may be an unattested toponym.

פֶּלֶע = פֶּלַח (fem.; Trg. פִּלְחָא), "cleavage, slice, mill-stone" (Job 41:16; *het-'ayin* interchange), from the root פֶּלַח, "to cleave"; cf. the personal name פִּלְחָא, *Pilha* (Neh. 10:25), in Hebrew would be פֶּלַח, *Pelah*.

As noted above, גֶּר may be defective spelling for גִּר, while פֶּלֶע a variant of בֶּלֶע, *Bela*. *Bela* was the first Edomite king (e.g., Gen. 36:32), the first born son of Benjamin (Gen. 46:21), the son of Azaz the Reubenite (1 Chron. 5:8), and the ancient name for the city Zoar in Moab (Gen. 14:2,8). בֶּלֶע,

39 Cf. SB, 106a-08b, 685a-89a, 697a-704b.

40 This name occurs in a "tablet having to do with going to Egypt & selling" (Text 2116:4; see UT, 289, 29*, 468 [#2054]). Dietrich and Loretz suggest that the personal name *plġn* (= *p/wurh?* + *n*) is of non-Semitic origin ("Untersuchungen zur Schrift- und Lautlehre des Ugaritischen (I)," WO 4 (1967-68), 302.

41 E.g., *pdy* - *pdyn*, *spr* - *spn*, *qrw* - *qrwn*, etc. (see *Ugaritic Textbook* [1965], 63). In Hebrew, e.g., שְׁלֵמָה - שְׁלֵמֹן (see #35, 8:8).

42 *Pella* is פֶּחַל or פֶּחַל, *Peḥal/Peḥel* of the Talmud; "Rabbi Zera went to חֶמְתָּא רִפְחָל (Hammeta or Hot-Spring by Peḥal)" (y. Shevi. 6:1 [18a]; cf. Jastrow, 481a, 1152b). פֶּחַל is Khirbat Tabaqat Fahil in Jordan, c. 8 miles southeast of Beth-Shean. See M. Avi-Yonah, "Palla or Paḥal," EJ 13, 219-20; Sh. Applebaum, "Decapolis," EJ 5, 1449-50; G.A. Smith, *The Historical Geography of the Holy Land* (1974), 398 n. 1; Y. Aharoni, *Carta's Atlas of the Bible* (Heb., 1974), 110 map 172, 125c. If the name *Pella* originates from פֶּחַל due to the weakening of the gutturals, it is unlikely that it would appear in the Scroll as פֶּלֶע.

43 BDB, 828b; cf. Harkavy 583b-84b. Traditionally rendered as, "When vengeance are inflicted upon Israel" (*Tanakh*); "In the time of tumultuous strife in Yisra'el" (Koren); etc.

Bela, בִּלְעָם, Balaam (e.g., Num. 22:5), the prophet-magician from Mesopotamia, the city בִּלְעָם, Balaam (1 Chron. 6:55), same as יִבְלְעָם, Ibleam (Josh. 17:11; Judg. 1:27) in Menasseh, all seem to be derived from the root בלע, “to swallow, engulf.” Moreover, בלע may be a metathesis for בַּעַל, “lord, owner, deity”; cf. כָּבֵשׁ vs. כָּבֵשׁ (see #60, 12:12).

גור appears in two toponyms: בְּמַעְלֵה גֹר אֲשֶׁר אֶת יִבְלְעָם, “at the Ascent of Gur, which is by Ibleam” (2 Kings 9:27) in Menasseh (cf. Judg. 1:27); and הָעֲרָבִים (כּ), הָעֲרָבִים, “the Arabs who dwell in Gur-baal” (2 Chron. 26:7), a city by the border of Judah and Edom. גור may be from the root גור, “to dwell, sojourn”; e.g., גֹּר בְּאֶרֶץ הַזֹּאת, “sojourn in this land” (Gen. 26:3). גור may mean a place for (temporary) dwelling; cf. שֵׁבֶת (fem.), “seat, dwelling” (e.g., 1 Kings. 10:19), שִׁיבָה (fem.), “sojourn” (2 Sam. 19:33), מוֹשֵׁב (masc.), “seat, dwelling-place (e.g., Gen. 10:30), all from the root ישב, “to seat, dwell.” Accordingly, גֹּר פֶּלַע, “Gur/Dwelling of Pela^c, a variant of גֹּר בִּלְעָם, Gur Bela^c, may be identical with גֹּר בַּעַל, Gur-baal or “Dwelling of Deity,” based on letter interchanges and metathesis. Moreover, מַעְלֵה גֹר, “Ascent of Gur/Dwelling,” near יִבְלְעָם, Ibleam, also known as בִּלְעָם, Balaam, may have been later named as גֹּר בִּלְעָם/פֶּלַע, Gur Bela^c/Pela^c.

גֹּד פֶּלַע, Gad/Fortune of Pela^c; “wall/riverbank/trench of (the) fissure/-Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of יְגָרִי/יָגוּר פֶּלַע, “Yegar/Yagur/Jagur/Heap of Pela^c”; “grave site/altar of (the) fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע = גִּיר פֶּלַע, “chalk stone of (the) fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, “deep-depression/Spring (the) fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע = גֶּן פֶּלַע, “Garden of Pela^c/Fissure”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע = גֵּל פֶּלַע, “Heap/grave/Spring of (the) fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע for גֹּר פֶּלַע, “elevation/middle of (the) fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע for גִּי פֶּלַע, “Valley of Fissure/Pela^c”; etc.

גֹּד פֶּלַע, a variant of גֹּד פֶּלַח, Gad/Fortune of Pelah; “wall/riverbank/trench of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of יְגָרִי/יָגוּר פֶּלַח, “Yegar/Yeger/Jagur/Heap of Pelah”; “grave/altar of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of גִּיר פֶּלַח, “chalk stone of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of גֹּר פֶּלַח, “deep-depression/ruin/Spring of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of גֶּן פֶּלַח, “Garden of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע, a variant of גֵּל פֶּלַח, “Heap/Spring of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע for גֹּר פֶּלַח, “elevation/middle of Pelah”; etc.

גֹּר פֶּלַע for גִּי פֶּלַח, “Valley of Pelah”; etc.

Finally, these suggestions can be further expanded if פֶּלַע is a variant of פֶּלַח, פרע, etc.

(9:16) **קַל שְׁבַה חֶרֶם** — ALLEGRO^{PF}: “in the chamber are the ‘Herem offerings’” (i.e., **בלשכה חרם**, לשכה, “chamber, cell”; with the definite article, “the Temple Treasury.” ALLEGRO: **בלשכה חרם**, but rendered as “all in it are consecrated offerings” (i.e., **כל שבה חרם**). ALLEGRO^{rev}: “everything in it is consecrated offering (*herem*).”⁴⁴ MILIK: **כל שבה חרם**, “everything in it is anathema.”⁴⁵ LURIE: **מלשכת חרם**, “(hidden a treasure) from the money of the Temple.” לשכה is the Treasury of the Temple (m. Sheq. 3:1). **חרם** means “dedicated to the Lord” (m. Arak. 8:6). Undefined *herem* must be given for Temple maintenance.⁴⁶ PIXNER, WOLTERS, GARCIA MARTINEZ, VERMES, and WISE basically follow Allegro^{rev}, but BEYER agrees with Milik.⁴⁷

קַל שְׁבַה means “everything which is in it (fem.),” i.e., the total content of the deep pit. The feminine possessive suffix indicates that here **שֵׁית** is feminine, although it is masculine in Mishnaic Hebrew. On the other hand, it can be vocalized as **קַל שְׁבַה**, the archaic spelling for **קַל שְׁבוּ**, “everything which is in it (masc.).” If so, **שֵׁית** is masculine (see #13, 3:9). In a similar phrase, **בְּצִירִיתִי וּבְצִירִיתִי שְׁבַאֲשָׁבָא ... בְּדִין וּבְדִין**, “In (the) Din ... in a/the ... in the catacomb/tower which is in it,” **שְׁבַאֲשָׁבָא** = **שְׁבַה וּשְׁבוּ**, can be masculine or feminine (see #37, 8:14). Also, the masculine form occurs in the phrase, **בְּבוֹרִי וּבְבוֹרִי ... וּבְמִזְקָא וּבְמִזְקָא שְׁבוּ**, “in a/the cistern/pit ... and in a/the channel which is in it (masc.)” (see #9, 2:9). **וְהוּא (ש) ב() ... ב()** means, “in (a/the) ... (which is) in it(s) ...” (see #3, 1:6:7; #11, 2:13-14; #37, 8:14; #45, 10:4; #54, 11:9). Regarding archaic spellings, see #13, 3:9.

בְּלִשְׁכַּת חֶרֶם (cf. Allegro), “in/at/by (the) cell/chamber of (the) *herem*,” is a possible but unlikely reading. **לְשִׁכָּה**, the construct state of **לִשְׁכָּה** (BH, MH, fem., pl. **לְשִׁכוֹת**, e.g., Ezek. 47:17; Aramaic **לְיִשְׁכָּתָא**, Trg. Jer. 35:4), means “cell, chamber, compartment”; e.g., **בְּלִשְׁכַּת גְּמַרְיָהוּ בֶן שַׁפָּן הַסּוֹפֵר**, “in the chamber of Gemariah son of Shaphan the scribe” (Jer. 36:10); **לְיִשְׁכַּת הָעֵץ**, “compartment of wood” (m. Mid. 5:4).⁴⁸ Accordingly, **בְּשֵׁיתִי בְּשֵׁית חֶרֶם**, “in the deep pit ... in (the) cell of *herem*,” would indicate that the deep pit had a cell for dedicated things, without disclosing its content. Regarding **חרם**, see #41, 9:10.

44 Allegro, 49, 158 n. 210; Allegro^{rev}, 25. Bardtke says that Allegro’s transcription is in error, instead of *blškh ḥrm* is better to read *kl šbh ḥrm* (“*Qumran und seine Probleme*,” *THR NF* [1968], 195). Based on “Allegro’s Provisional Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll,” Allegro subsequently accepted Milik’s version, yet he must have forgot to change **חרם** into *kl šbh ḥrm* in his manuscript for his book.

45 Milik, 294-95, 249 C-117; Milik^E, 141 (the phrase, “everything in it,” is missing).

46 Lurie, 110-12 and n 6.

47 Pixner, 353; Wolters, 48-49; Garcia Martinez, 462; Vermes, 377; Wise, 196; Beyer, 230-31.

48 **נְשִׁכָּה**, a variant of **לְשִׁכָּה**, occurs in Neh. 3:30, 12:44, 13:7, a *lamed-nun* interchange.

ITEM 44

9:17 בשובך שבמצד נאבחה מן ה- <[
10:1 דרום בעליאה השנית ירידתו
10:2 מלמעלא ככ 9

9:17 In the tower which is at the Fort of Nobah, o[n the]
10:1 south, in the second level, its descent is
10:2 from above, (there are) 9 s(ilver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(9:17-10:1) בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙ (= בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙) שְׁבַמְצַד נֹאֲבַחַ מִן הַ[דְּרוֹם (נוֹבַחַ) מִן הַ] דְּרוֹם, “In/at/by a/the tower/dovecote/drain which is at (the) Fort of Nobah, o[n/from/to the] south” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the net which is in the raw flesh trap in ... to the South” (i.e., בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙ דְּרוֹם). Jastrow (822b) gives מְצַד מְצַד, “net, trap”; מְצַד (BH), “net,” מְצַד (BH), “fastness, stronghold.” נָא (“raw,” Exod. 12:9) is in opposition of בָּשָׁל (“cooked”). ALLEGRO: בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙ פֶּתַח דְּרוֹם, “In the gutter (?) that is in the Stronghold of Senaah (?), opening to the south.” מְצַדִּינָה is contracted from מְצַד סִנְאָה, it may be Archelais. Eusebius has Magdalsenna (*Onomasticon*, 154:16), i.e., מִגְדַּל סִנְאָה, Tower of Sena’a; cf. בְּנֵי סִנְאָה (Ezra 2:35; Neh. 7:38). The text has בָּתַח for פֶּתַח; cf. הַפְּנָא for הַבְּנָא (6:7). ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the sluice (?) that in the stronghold of [...] south.”¹ MILIK: [מִים] בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙, “In the *man-hole* (found) in the aque[duct] of ha-Masad, on the south side.” מְצַד is Masada.² LURIE: בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙, renders בְּצֵד דְּרוֹם, “In the dove-cote (hewn in the rock) in the Nabatean stronghold, in the south side.” [נֹאֲבַחַ] אֵהָ, appears in the Talmud as נִבְּטִיָּה, נִבְּטִיָּה, נִבְּטִיָּה (B.B. 56a, etc.). The stronghold was named after the Nabatean soldiers who encamped there; etc.³ PIXNER: “At the dove cot which is at the Nabatean Fort בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙ (south of.”⁴ THORION: It is uncertain whether in PIXNER’s reading of בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙בְּשׁוּבְךָ֙ אֵהָ the *alef* represents a vocal “a” or not.⁵ WOLTERS:

1 Allegro, 49, 51, 150 n. 130, 156-57 n. 187, 160 nn. 224-25; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 294-95, 238-239 C-4, 269 D-37, 242-43 C-58; Milik^E, 141, 151.

3 Lurie, 102-107 n. 1, 112 and n. 2 (the letter space between נִבְּטִיָּה and [הָא] is a typographical error).

4 Pixner, 353 and n. 38 (the letter space between נִבְּטִיָּה and [הָא] is a typographical error).

5 Thorion, 168.

דרום [...], "In the columbarium which is in the defile of Obboth [...] south."⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "In the dovecote of the fortress of Nabata [...] to the South."⁷ BEYER: דרום [בתחום] שבמצודת, "In the dovecote which is in Masadona (the small mountain citadel in Aramaic; an unknown place), in the southern district."⁸ VERMES: "At the 'dovecot' which is at Mesad, at the [water] conduit southward."⁹ WISE: "At the dovecote that is in the Fortress of Nobah, at the bor[der] on the south."¹⁰

The rest of the line after בשובך consists of: *šin*, *bet/mem*, *šade*, *dalet/reš*, *nun*, *ʾalef*, *bet/kaf*, *he/ħet/taw*, a letter fragment, and a lacuna that extends to the middle of the next column (perhaps up to five letters are missing). The letter fragment may be part of a *bet*, *dalet*, *he*, *ħet*, *kaf*, final *kaf*, *mem*, final *pe*, *reš*, or *taw*; it may belong to the previous or missing word.

The first word, בשובך or בשובך, "in/at/by a/the tower/dovecote/catacomb," can also be vocalized as בשובך or בשובך, variants of בשובך or בשובך, "in/at/by a/the drain" (*bet-pe* interchange). See #38, 9:1.

The second word is -שב, "which is in (the)," plus מצר or מצר, where the *mem* is locative. If it is followed by a noun, it is in the construct state. מצר (from the root צוד, "to hunt") or מצר (from the root צור - צר, "to bind, confine, besiege") can be read, vocalized, and interpreted as follows.

מצר (masc., pl. מצודות) and מצודה (fem., pl. מצודות), "stronghold, fort" — e.g. וישב דוד במצד ... וילכד דוד את מצודת ציון, "And David took the stronghold of Zion (fem.) ... And David resided in the stronghold (masc.);" (1 Chron. 11:5,7).

מצור (masc., pl. מצודים) and מצודה (fem.), "siege work, bulwark" — e.g., מצודים גדלים, "mighty siege works" (Eccl. 9:14); ומצדותה, "and the bulwarks about her" (Isa. 29:7; see Radak and *Mešudat Zion*). מצודה (fem.) also means "(fish-)net" (Lam. 9:12).

מצור (masc.) and מצורה (fem., pl. מצורות), "fort, stronghold" — e.g., ערי מצור, "fortified cities with walls" (2 Chron. 8:5); ערי מצורה, "fortified cities" (2 Chron. 14:5).

מצור (masc.), "siege work" — e.g., במצור בירושלם, "in the siege in Jerusalem" (2 Chron. 32:10).

מצור (masc.), "depth" or "Egypt" — cf. יארי מצור and its Targumim מי נהרין עמיקין, "waters of deep rivers" (2 Kgs 19:24; Isa. 37:25), and נהריהון עמיקיא, "their deep rivers" (Isa. 19:6). In these verses (as well as in Micah 7:12), מצור, could be the singular form of מצרים (dual), Egypt (cf. Radak).

⁶ Wolters, 48-49.

⁷ Garcia Martinez, 463.

⁸ Beyer, 230-31.

⁹ Vermes, 377.

¹⁰ Wise, 196. This is similar to the reading suggested by this writer; see Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 715, 719.

If the next letter is added to מִצָּר, then מִצָּרָן = מִצְרָן (cf. Wolters) may be a defective or contracted form of מִצְרַיִם, Egypt. Accordingly, some wealth may have been hidden in Egypt. Regarding contracted forms, see #30, 7:8-9.

מֵצָר (masc., pl. מְצָרִים, BH) means “narrow, pass, distress, boundary” (e.g., Ps. 118:5; Lam. 1:3), so מֵיֵצָר in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. B.B. 7:3) מֵצָר מֵיֵצָר - מְצָאוֹ מֵיֵצָר in Talmudic Aramaic (e.g., b. B.M., 108b).

Determining the proper meaning of the third word and its adjacent lacuna presents a major challenge. If the third word consists of four letters, then the fragment must be the first letter for the next missing word. In addition to the suggestions by the scholars, the following are offered.

בְּשׁוֹרָה בְּשׁוֹרָה בְּשׁוֹרָה בְּשׁוֹרָה שְׂבַמְצוֹר שְׂבַמְצוֹר נֹב (= נוֹב), תַּחַת
 "In/at/by a/the tower/dove-
 cote/catacomb/drain which is in (the) fort/pass/border of Nob, below" — נֹב
 is a variant of נוֹב, Nob. Cf. עִיר הַכֹּהֲנִים, "Nob the city of the Priests" in
 Benjamin (1 Sam. 22:11,19; see #2, 1:5).

בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ, or בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ בְּשׁוֹרְבָּהּ (= נֹבַח) In/at/by a/the tower/dovecote/catacomb/drain which is in/at/by a/the fort/pass/border of Nobah" — נֹבַח is a variant of נֹבַח, Nobah (Num. 32:42; Judg. 8:11); the *'alef* may indicate a Tiberian *holam*. Cf. שְׂמָאוֹל and שְׂמָאֵל (BH) vs. סְמֹל and סְמֹל (CS, see #5, 1:13). Nobah from the Tribe of Menasseh conquered Kenath and its surrounding towns, which he named after himself (Num. 32:42). נֹבַח may be the same as נֹפַח, Nophah (Num. 21:30; *bet-pe* interchange).

בְּשׁוֹכְנֵי בִשְׁוֹבֵי בִשְׁוֹבֵי שְׁבִמְצוֹר שְׁבִמְצוֹר נָאֶתְנָאֵת (= נְבָתוֹנָת) or
בְּשׁוֹכְנֵי בִשְׁוֹבֵי בִשְׁוֹבֵי שְׁבִמְצוֹר שְׁבִמְצוֹר נָאֶתְנָאֵת, “In/at/by a/the
tower/dovecote/catacomb/drain which is in the fort/pass/border of Nevat/-
Naboth/Nabatea” — נָאֵת = נָבֹת, Naboth; cf. הַבּוֹאֵת for הַבּוֹאֵת (see #1,
1:2). נָבֹת הַיְזְרְעֵלִי, Naboth the Jezreelite was killed by Jezebel, so that her
husband King Ahab could take כְּרָם נָבֹת, “vineyard of Naboth,” or שָׂדֵה
נָבֹת, “field of Naboth” (1 Kgs Ch 21; 2 Kgs Ch. 9). In addition, נָאֵת =
נָבֵת or נְבֵאֵת = נָבֹת may be singular or variant of נְבֵאִיתוֹנִיּוֹת, Nebaiioth son
of Ishmael (Gen. 25:13, etc.), and a nation (Isa. 60:7). First two sons of Ish-
mael, נְבֵאִיתוֹ וְקֶדָר, “Nebaiioth and Kedar,” is rendered by the Targum as נְבֵט
וְעֶרֶב, “Nabatea and Arabia” (1 Chron. 1:29), a *tet-taw* interchange¹¹ (cf.
Pixner’s suggestion).

11 See *The Living Torah*, 115. The Nabateans were Arabs or related to them. They established their kingdom in the ancient territory of Edom, and called themselves נבטו. E.g., חרתת מלך נבטו, "Haratat, king of the Nabateans," in a funeral inscription from Madeba (37 CE). See H. Ingholt, "Palmyrene — Hatran — Nabataean," *An Aramaic Handbook*, (1967), Part 1/1, 48 (#3). Also, [eds.,] "Nabateans," *EJ* 12, 739; A. Negev, "נבטים" in *EH* 24, 817-18. Regarding the letter interchange, cf. חרת - חרט, חתף - חטף; see #32, 7:15; #34, 8:4-5; also SB, 282a-83a.

ITEM 45

10:3 בבור גר מזקות שרוי מהנחל

10:4 הגדול בקרקעו ככ 12

10:3 In the cistern of the deep depression of the canals,
which is irrigated by the Great

10:4 River, in its ground (are) 12 s(ilver) k(arsh).

COMMENTARY

(10:3-4) בבור גר מזקות שרוי מהנחל הגדול, "In/at/by a/(the) cistern of (the) deep depression of (the) canals which is irrigated from/by the Great River" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "In the plastered irrigation cistern (?) which is fed from the Great Wady" (i.e., בבור גר מזקות שרוי מהנחל הגדול, בור, "pit," or כור, "furnace"; גר, "lime" (?). זקק מוקות from the root זקק, "to refine," which fits with כור and גר, but if the reading is בור, then the Aramaic מויקתא (cf. זיקא), "irrigation channel," is better. Perhaps, "a plastered cistern for irrigation." ALLEGRO: בבור גי <ע>מוקות שרוי מהנחל הגדול, "In the cistern of the Ravine of the Deeps which is fed from the Great Wady." גי for גדגרג as in 9:15; גי מוקות for גי עמוקות שרוי; גי from the root רוי (cf. 8:14); the Great Wady may be Wadi Farah-Kelt. ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the cistern which is alongside the irrigation channels that are fed from the Great Wadi."¹ MILIK^{org}: "In the cistern of *Grm* ..." (i.e., בבור גרם; cf. Hill of Gareb (i.e., גבעת גרב, Jer. 31:38. MILIK: בכירגר מוקות שרוי מהנחל הגדול, "In the *well* for the irrigation ditches fed from the Great Torrent." כירגר is like the Judeo-Aramaic גרגר, etc., "well for irrigating" (cf. Jastrow, 264-65). Alternately, בבור גב, where the bottom of the last *bet* is missing.² GREENFIELD takes "strong exception" to MILIK's interpretation of בכירגר.³ LURIE: בבור גי מוקות שרוי מהנחל הגדול, "In the cistern of the valley of the channels that receive its water from the Great River." מוקות means "water channel"; cf. Trg. 1 Kgs 18:32; 2 Kgs 18:17. רוייה שרוי. AHARONI: הנחל הגדול, Great Nahal, or "big valley," may be the Kidron Valley.⁵ PIXNER: "At the waterwheel for

¹ Allegro, 51, 156 n. 181, 160-61, nn. 229-32; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

² Milik^F, 327, 339-40; Milik, 295-96, 229 B-11c, 241 C-42-43, 243 C-61, 244 C-72, 266 D-22. Milik^E, 141 (there are some typographical errors).

³ Greenfield, 139b.

⁴ Lurie, 113 and n. 2.

⁵ Y. Aharoni, "Excavations at Ramat Raḥel," *BA* 24 (1961), 114-17; *Excavations at*

irrigation (מִהֲנַחַל), which is fed from the Nahal Ha-Gadol (הַגְדוֹל). The Great River may be the Yarmuk.⁶ THORION: <ע-מוקות (?) is one of those words in which the *ayin* is missing; שְׂרוּ (?), the *šin* is considered as a relative pronoun, but it is a problematic word.⁷ WOLTERS: בְּבוֹר, "In the lime-plastered cistern of the conduits which draw water from the Great Wadi."⁸ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "In the water-wheel (?) of the irrigation ditches fed by the great stream."⁹ BEYER: בְּבוֹר גֵּר, "In the floor of a plastered cistern with a water conduit, fed by the great Wadi."¹⁰ VERMES: "In the cistern next to the canals fed by the Great Wady."¹¹ WISE agree with Wolters.¹²

The first word, בְּבוֹר, "in a/(the) cistern/pit of," is a noun in the construct state (same as בְּבוֹר שֶׁל). It is also possible to read as בְּכוֹרִיבְכוֹר, "in a/(the) furnace/smelter of" (cf. Allegro^{pr}), and even בְּכוֹרִיבְכוֹר (the *reš* is a short-legged final *kaf*), "in a/(the) burial niche of" (see #3, 1:6).

The second word, which appears earlier, can be read as גֵּד (with *dalet*), גֵּר (with *reš*), גו (the *reš* is a long-headed *waw*), or גִּי (the *reš* is a long-headed *yod*; see #43, 9:15). This term seems to be in the construct state. The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations.

גֵּד — גֵּדֶה (H, A), "Gad, luck, fortune," (name of a person, tribe, toponym, deity); may be an unattested masculine form of גֵּדָה (fem.), "wall (of), riverbank (of)."

גֵּר, "spring (of)," "deep depression (of)," or perhaps "ruin (of)."

גֵּר = גִּיר (masc.), "chalk, plaster (of)."

גֵּר = גוּר, "Gur (of)"; גֵּר may be a variant of יְגָרִיבְיָגוּר, "Yegar/Yeger/Jagur, (stone) heap (of), grave site (of), altar (of)."

גֵּר a variant of גֵּן (masc.), "garden (of)" (*reš-nun* interchange).

גֵּר a variant of גֵּל (masc.; cf. Milik), "heap, grave site, well, wave, door hinge (of)" (*lamed-reš* interchange).

גֵּר for גו (masc.), "back, body (of)" (the *reš* is a long-headed *waw*).

גֵּר for גו - גו (masc.), "midst, middle (of)" (the *reš* is a long-headed *waw*).

גֵּר for גִּי, "valley (of)" (the *reš* is a long-headed *yod*).

The third word consists of the letters *mem*, *waw/zayin/yod*, *qof*, *waw/zayin/yod*, and *taw* that may be read as a *he/het*; cf. הדרומית for תדרומית.

Ramat Rahel, Seasons 1959 and 1960 (1962), 49-51, 60; *Excavations at Ramat Rahel, Seasons 1961 and 1962* (1964), 122-24.

6 Pixner, 336, 350 n. 28, 353-54 (מִנַּחַל is a typographical error for מִהֲנַחַל) and n. 39, 358 n. 52, 360.

7 Thorion, 168; 169, n. 26.

8 Wolters, 50-51.

9 Garcia Martinez, 463.

10 Beyer, 230-31.

11 Vermes, 377.

12 Wise, 196.

(3:1-2) in Allegro's drawing. In the Scroll *he*, *het*, and *taw* are often indistinguishable, however, in most cases the *taw* is lacking its left foot. This word may be a singular or plural noun or adjective. It can be read, vocalized, and translated as follows.

מִזְקוֹת, "canals," is the plural of מִזְקָה (fem.), "canal," which occurs earlier in the Scroll. It may be an Aramaic loanword (see #9, 2:9).

מִזְקוֹת = מִזְקוֹת, "demonesses," could be a feminine plural form of מִזְק (MH, masc., pl. (מִזְקִים), "one who does damage," also "demon" (from the root נִזַּק, "to harm, destroy"). Cf. וּבְשֶׁהֲזִיק חָב הַמִּזְזִיק לְשָׁלֵם תְּשָׁלוּמֵי נִזָּק, "and (when) one has caused damage, (the owner of the) damage-maker is liable to pay compensation for the damage" (m. B.Q. 1:1); מִפְּנֵי הַמִּזְקִים, "because of the demons" (b. Ber. 3a).¹³

מִיקָה = מִקָּה (masc. sg.) or מִיקָה = מִקָּה (fem. sg.), "gathering," especially "gathering of water, ritual bath, *mikve*" (from the root יָקַח, "to collect, gather"). The *yod* may represent a Tiberian short *hiriq*; cf. =) נִיקְרַת הַשְּׂבִילָה (see #4, 1:12). מִקָּה and מִקָּה occur earlier as alternate readings: הַמִּקְוָה[א], הַמִּקְוָה[א], or הַמִּקְוָה[א] (see #30, 7:8).

מִיקוֹת = מִקּוֹת = מִקּוֹאוֹת, "*mikves*," plural of מִקָּה (masc.) or מִקָּה (fem.). A single *waw* instead of the usual double *waw*; cf. וְאֵת מִקּוֹת הַמַּיִם, "and the water reservoirs (or *mikves*)" (m. M.Q. 1:2); also שְׁלֹשָׁה מִקּוֹאוֹת, "three *mikves*" (m. Miq. 6:3).

מִיקָה = מִקָּה (masc.), the same as תִּקְוָה (fem.), "hope" (both are from the root יָקַח, "to wait"). E.g., יֵשׁ מִקָּה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, "there is hope for Israel" (Ezra 10:2); מִקָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל ה', "Hope of Israel! Lord!" (Jer. 17:13; const.); וְאֵת עֲמָק עֶכּוֹר לִפְתַּח תִּקְוָה, "and (I will make) the Valley of Achor/-Disturbance into the Gate of Hope" (Hosea 2:17; for Achor, see #1, 1:1).

עֲמָקִים (Allegro), the *ayin* is dropped; cf. דְּמָעָה (see #55, 11:14) and הַמְּעָרָב (alt., see #56, 12:11). The adjective עֲמָק (masc. sg.) means "deep" (from the root עָמַק, "to be deep"); e.g., וְלֵב עֲמָק, "and a deep heart" (Ps. 64:7); שׁוֹתָה עֲמָקָה, "a deep pit" (Prov. 22:14, 23:27; fem. sg.); מַיִם עֲמָקִים, "Deep waters (these are) words of man's mouth; a gushing stream (this is) a fountain of wisdom" (Prov. 18:4; masc. pl.); and מְגַלֵּה עֲמָקוֹת, "He reveals the depths (i.e., mysteries)" (fem. pl.; Job 12:22). עֲמָק, "valley," is also derived from this root (see #1, 1:1).

The fourth word consists of the letters *šin/šin*, *dalet/reš*, *waw/yod*, and *waw/yod*. In addition, often the *mem/nun* of the plural יָם-יָם ending is miss-

13 The Aramaic forms are (also masc.): מִזְזִיק (sg.), מִזְזִיקָא (sg. emph.), מִזְזִיקִין (pl.), מִזְזִיקָא (pl. emph.), and מִזְזִיקִי (pl. const.). The Mishnaic Hebrew verbal and nominal forms of נִזַּק may be Aramaic loanwords, although נִזָּק (masc.), "damage," once occurs in Late Biblical Hebrew (Esth. 7:4). Moreover, the *Hif'il* masculine participle forms are מִזְזִיק and מִזְזִיקִים, "who is/are causing damage" (also used as nouns); the feminine forms are מִזְזִיקָה (sg.) and מִזְזִיקוֹת (pl.), "who is/are causing damage."

ing. Also, *yod* in final position may be interchanged with a *he*, especially, if the preceding vocal is a *šere* or *segol*.¹⁴ Accordingly, this word can be read as שדוו, שדוי, שרוו, and שרוי. The basic question is whether the *šin* is the first letter of the root, or it is the relative *šin*, and whether it refers to the first word בור (singular) or to the second and third (singular or plural). If so, שרוו or שרוי may consist of the relative -ש = אָשֶׁר, "which is," plus ווו or רוי (from the root רוה - רוי, "to drink, saturate," BH, MH, A).¹⁵ רוה in *Qal* means, "to drink, moist, water," and in *Pi'el*, "to saturate, irrigate, delight."¹⁶ רוי may be a variant of רוה (*yod-he* interchange in final position). The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations.

שָׂרוּי (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg.), "(it is, masc.) soaked" (from the root שרה, "to soak, dissolve"); e.g., בִּרְקִיקַי הַשָּׂרוּי, "with the soaked cake" (t. Pes. 1:31; cf. the baraitot in y. Pes. 3:1 [18a]; b. Ber. 38b; b. Pes. 41a); אֵין שָׂרוּיִן, "he soaked his bread in wine" (m. Naz. 6:1); טִיט בְּרִשּׁוֹת הָרְבִים, "One is not allowed to soak clay in the public domain" (m. B.M. 10:5).¹⁷

14 Often final *he* is represented by a *yod* in roots of third radical *he* (originally *yod*). E.g., Masoretic Text: וּבְמַרְאֵי עֵינֶיךָ (*ketiv*), vs. וּבְמַרְאֵה עֵינֶיךָ (*qeri*), "and in the sight of your eyes" (Eccl. 11:9); Dead Sea Scrolls: צוי (= צוה, 1QISa 38:1; in the MT צו), "instruct"; Samaritan Pentateuch: נשקי vs. נשקה, "let us make drink" (MT, Gen. 19:32); in the Mishnah: שָׁוִי (MS) vs. שָׁוֶה, "equivalent" (printed, m. R. ha-Sh. 3:5). See *MNM* 2, 1251-52; *LLBS*, 118-19; E. Qimron, *The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1986), 20. The opposite, *he* instead of *yod*, also occurs in the Masoretic Text; e.g., וַיִּשְׂאוּ קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכוּ בְּכִי גָדוֹל, "and they raised their voices and wept (in) loud weeping" (Judg. 21:2), vs. כִּי בָכוּ הָעָם הַרְבֵּה בְּכָה, "because the people wept much weeping" (Ezra 10:1); i.e., בְּכִיבְכִי vs. בְּכָה; cf. Rashi on the latter verse). Furthermore, more than a dozen Hebrew trilateral roots have the מִשְׁקָל (pattern) פוה ע"ו plus ל"ה, i.e., second radical weak, third radical *he*. Those having *Qal* formation, the passive participles (also used as nouns and adjectives) are: פָּוִי (masc. sg.), פְּוִיָּה (fem. sg.), פְּוִיִּים (masc. pl.), and פְּוִיּוֹת (fem. pl.).

15 There is a second root for ראה, a variant of רוה, "be saturated," an *alef-waw* interchange (e.g., Isa. 53:11). There are more than a dozen Hebrew trilateral roots of the מִשְׁקָל (pattern) פוה ע"ו plus ל"ה, i.e., second radical weak, third radical *he* (or *yod*).

16 E.g., "What is the meaning of (the name) רוּת (Ruth)? Rabbi Johanan said, 'Because she was privileged to to be an ancestor of (King) David שָׂרְוָה (because he delighted Him) the Holy One, may be blessed His name, with songs and hymns'" (b. Ber. 7b; cf. B.B. 14b). Accordingly, the name רוּת, Ruth, is derived from the root רוה. Also cf. וּמַרְוֶה גַם הוּא יִרְאֶה, "and he who satisfies abundantly shall be satisfied also himself" (Prov. 11:25; verbal forms); כְּגֵן רוֹה, "like a well-watered garden" (Isa. 58:11; Jer. 30:12; masc. adj.); וַתּוֹצִיאֵנוּ לְרוּיָהּ, "and You (God) brought us to a place of abundance" (Ps. 66:12; fem. noun).

17 In the Masoretic Text שרה occurs in מִשְׁרַת עֲנָבִים, which is rendered by Onkelos as מִתְרוֹת עֲנָבִין (*šin-taw* interchange), "juice (fem.) of grapes" (Num. 6:3). See Rashi, Rashbam, Ibn-Ezra, Malbim, Sifri (Naso' 89). Since the Aramaic cognate of שרה is תרא - תרי, it cannot be a *šafel* form of רוה. Other similar roots are: יִשְׁרִי - יִשְׁרָה (MH), "to rest, dwell, camp"; יִשְׁרִי - יִשְׁרָה, *Qal* (MH), "to open, untie" (e.g., t. Ber. 7:8), *Pi'el* (BH), "to save" (Jer. 15:11); יִשְׁרִי - יִשְׁרָה, *Hif'il* (MH), "to sustain" (m. Ket. 5:8); שָׂרִי - שָׂרָה, "to wrestle" (Gen. 32:29; Hos. 12:4). Regarding the Scroll, these roots seem to be irrelevant.

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי or שָׂרוּיִם (Qal pass. part. masc. pl.; שְׂ is a shortened form of יָס־וֹיִן, rather than construct state; see #13, 3:9; Appendix D), “(they are) soaked”; e.g., סִמָּנִים שָׂרוּיִן, “soaked drugs/paints” (b. Shab. 90a).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּה = שָׂרוּה, “which is watering” or “which waters” — (Qal act. part. masc. sg.), “(it) is watering” or “(it, masc.) water(s)”; cf. וְלִמְלֶךְ אֵין שׁוּה לְהִנָּחֵם, “and for the king it is not appropriate to tolerate them” (Esth. 3:8; from the root שׁוּה - שׁוּי, “to be smooth, even”).

שָׂרוּי or שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּיִם = שָׂרוּיִם, “which they are watering” or “which they water” — רֹי or רֹיִן for רֹיִם (Qal act. part. masc. pl.), “(they, masc.) are watering” or “(they, masc.) water”; cf. וְקֹי ה', “and those whose hope in the Lord” (Isa. 40:31; Ps. 37:9; const.; from the root קוּה - קוּי, “to wait, hope”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי, “which is watered” — רֹי (Qal pass. part. masc. sg.), “(it, masc.) is watered”;¹⁸ טוּי וְאַרְוֵג, “spun or woven” (m. Kil. 9:8; used as an adjective; from the root טוּה - טוּי, “to spin”); עָשׂוּי, “it (masc.) is made” (e.g., Ezek. 40:17; m. Dem. 5:1-2).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּיִם = שָׂרוּיִם or שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּיִם (Qal pass. part. masc. pl.; שְׂ is a shortened form of יָס־וֹיִן; see #13, 3:9; Appendix D), “(they, masc.) are watered”; cf. יָדוּ הַדְּרוּיִם, “the afflicted shall mourn” (b. Naz. 23a; from the root דוּה - דוּי, “to be ill”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּה = שָׂרוּה, “which watered (in the past)” — רֹה (Qal perf. masc. third pers. sg.), “it (masc.) watered”; cf. עָלָנוּ הָיָה דְּרוּה לְבַנּוּ, “for this our heart was ill” (Lam. 5:17; from the root דוּה - דוּי, “to be ill”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי, “which they watered (in the past)” — רֹי (Qal, perf. pl. third pers.), “they watered”; cf. וְכָל הַנָּשִׁים ... טוּוּ אֶת הָעִזִּים, “And all the women ... spun the goat hair” (Exod. 35:26); שָׂעוּ, “which (they) committed iniquities” (m. Yoma 6:2; from the root עוּה - עוּי, “to bend, twist”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּה = שָׂרוּה, “which (is/are) watering” — רֹה (Qal maqor - gerund), “watering”; cf. וַעֲשֵׂה אֶתְּךָ יוֹם מְשֻׁתָּה וְשִׂמְחָה, “making a day of feasting and gladness” (Esth. 9:17-18).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי, “which they saturated (in the past)” — רֹי (Pi'el perf. third pers. pl.), “they saturated”; cf. כְּאֲשֶׁר קִוּוּ נַפְשִׁי, “as they hoped (to have) my life” (Ps. 56:7); וּפָנּוּ אֶת הַבַּיִת, “and they emptied the house” (Lev. 14:16 (from the root פָּנָה - פָּנִי, “to turn, clear”)); כְּאֲשֶׁר כָּלוּ לֶאֱכֹל, “as they finished to eat” (Gen. 43:2; from the root כָּלָה - כָּלִי, “to complete”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּה = שָׂרוּה, “which is/are saturating” — רֹה (Pi'el maqor - gerund), “saturating”; cf. קָוָה קִוִּיתִי ה', “I have greatly hoped” (Ps. 40:2).

¹⁸ רֹוִיָּה (fem.) as an adjective occurs in the Middle Age Hebrew literature (see ESH^{dic} 6, 2482b).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּה = אֲשֶׁר רוּה, “which is/are saturating” — רוּה (*Pi’el maqor* - gerund), “saturating”; e.g., תִּלְמִיָּה רוּה (= לְרוּה = לְרוּוֹת), “saturating its (fem.) ridges” (Ps. 65:11; cf. Rashi, Malbim);¹⁹ קָוָה לְשָׁלוֹם, “hoping for peace” (Jer. 8:15; cf. Radak).

שָׂרוּי = אֲשֶׁר רוּו, “which were saturated (in the past)” — רוּו (*Pu’al* perf. third pers. pl.), “they were saturated”; cf. לָעֲנָה וְרוֹשׁ שָׁבְעוּ וְרוּו, “They were sated and saturated with wormwood and gall” (in one of Kallir’s *qinot*, elegy);²⁰ לֹא נָכוּ, “they were not ruined” (Exod., 9:32; from the root נָכָה - נָכִי, “to end”); כָּלוּ (= כָּלוּ) תַּפְלוֹת דָּוִד בֶּן יִשָּׁי, “The prayers of David son of Jesse are ended” (Ps. 72:20); כָּסּוּ (= כָּסּוּ) הָרִים, “the mountains were covered” (Ps. 80:11; from the root כָּסָה - כָּסִי, “to cover”).

שָׂרוּי = שָׂרוּי = אֲשֶׁר רוּוִי, “which is an/(the) irrigation” — רוּוִי (masc.) means “irrigation”; cf. הִשְׁתִּיל שְׁתִּילֵי עֵדֶן בְּרוּוִי עֲנִיַּת טַל, “(God) planted the plants of (the Garden of) Eden with an irrigation (of) cloud of dew,” in one of Kallir’s *piyyuṭim*.²¹

As can be seen, the word in question can be *Qal*, *Pi’el*, *Pu’al*, active participle, passive participle, past tense, singular (i.e., referring to בּוֹר, or if the third word is singular), or plural (i.e., referring to the third word if it is plural), gerund, and even a noun.

There are other possible readings for the word in question, such as שָׁדִי, “which is sick”; cf. וְכָל לֵב דָּי, “and every heart is ill” (Isa. 1:5; adj.); שָׁדִי, “which is afflicted”; cf. יָדוּוּ הַדְּוִיִּים, “the afflicted shall mourn” (b. Naz. 23a; mentioned above). However, as pertaining the Scroll, these possibilities seem to be irrelevant.

In the next phrase, מִהַנַּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “from the great river,” both noun and adjective are prefixed with the definite article; cf. הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל, “the high priest.” This is the normal biblical usage (e.g., Lev. 21:10; see #28, 6:14-7:1). נַחַל (masc.), “river, torrent, stream, wady, valley,” appears earlier in the Scroll, שֶׁבְנַחַל הַכְּפָאֵה־כְּפָא, “which is in/at/by the Wadi of the Dome-/Kefah/Rock” (see #24, 5:12). Both מִן הַנַּחַל and its contracted form מִהַנַּחַל, “from the river,” occur in the Masoretic Text (1 Sam. 17:40; 1 Kgs 17:6; and 1 Kgs 17:4, respectively). The adjective גָּדוֹל (masc.) - גְּדוֹלָה (fem.), “great, large, big,” appears eight times in the Scroll (see #28, 7:1).

הַנַּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “the Great River,” may refer to the Jordan, the largest river in Palestine; cf. הַנְּהַר הַגָּדוֹל נְהַר פָּרַת, “the Great River, River of Euphrates”

19 Mandelkern (2, 1078b) considers it as a *Pi’el* imperative form.

20 In the seventh paragraph of הַשְׁוֹן יִשְׁבֶּה חֲבַצְלֵת הַשְׁוֹן. See A. Rosenfeld, *The Authorized Kinot for the Ninth of Av* (1970), 100; also ESh^{dic}, 6, 2482a.

21 In the *piyyuṭ* אֶזְאִגְרָה in “The Prayer for Dew” (Musaf Service for the first day of Pasover), each letter of the Alphabet is allotted four lines, and each line ends with טַלְטַל either as an independent word or as a syllable. This citation is the third line of the letter *he*. Concerning רוּי, see the commentaries of *Beth Levi* and *Maṭṭeh Levi* there.

(Gen. 15:18; Deut. 1:7; Josh. 1:4); הַנָּהָר הַגָּדוֹל הוּא חֲדָקָל, “the Great River, that is Tigris” (Dan. 10:4); הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל, “the Great Sea,” i.e., the Mediterranean Sea (Num. 34:6-7; etc.).

There are four major problems with this item: (1) the reading of the second word; (2) the reading of the third word, which is a plural feminine noun or adjective; (3) whether the second and third words form a single unit; (4) the reading of the fourth word, and whether it refers to the first or to the second and third words.

The following are some possible interpretations of the first phrase. Since the fifth word מִהַנָּחַל means “from the river,” it is easier to explain the preceding verbal form in a passive manner. In any case, only three readings of the third word are given: שָׂרוּי, “which is soaked,” and שָׂרוּי, “which is watered,” basically referring to בּוֹר (masc. sg.), “cistern, pit,” as well as שָׂרוּי, “which were saturated (in the past),” referring to the plural מְקוֹת, “canals,” etc. For the other possibilities, the reader can substitute the word in question. Some of these suggestions lack the definite article, although the construct state often connotes definiteness.

בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוּהַּמִּיקוּהַּמִּיקוּת שָׂרוּי־שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern/pit of plaster of (the) gathering(s) (of water) which is fed/soaked by the Great River,” or perhaps it means ... בְּבוֹר גֵּר שֶׁל הַמִּקְוֹה־הַמִּקְוֹה־הַמִּקְוֹת, “in a plastered cistern of the mikve(s) ...”; i.e., the cistern is fed by the Great River. Cf. בּוֹר סִידוֹסִיד מֵאֶבֶד טִיפָּה, “(like) a cistern of plaster (or plastered cistern) which does not lose a drop (water)” (m. ’Avot 2:11).²² סִיד (MH, A) - שִׁיד (BH, masc.), is a synonym of גֵּיר (BH, BA), “chalk, plaster”; cf. וְשִׁידָת אֶתְּם בְּשִׁיד, and its Targumim, וְתִסְדוּ יִתְהוֹן בְּסִידָא (TO), and וְתִשְׁעוּנָן יִתְהוֹן בְּגִידָאָה (PsJ, TN), “and you shall plaster them with plaster” (Deut. 27:2).

בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוּת שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern/pit of plaster (or plastered cistern) of (the) gatherings (of water, or mikves) which were fed by the Great River” — In the past the mikves were fed by the Great River.

בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִיְקוּהַּמִּיקוּהַּמִּיקוּת שָׂרוּי־שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune Gathering(s)/Pool(s) which is being fed/soaked by the Great River.”

בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִיְקוּת שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune Gatherings/Pools which were fed by the Great River.”

בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִיְקוּהַּ שָׂרוּי־שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune of Hope which is being fed/soaked by the Great River.”

בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוּהַּמִּיקוּהַּמִּיקוּת שָׂרוּי־שָׂרוּי מִהַנָּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “in a/(the) cistern of (the) Spring of Gathering(s) which is being fed/soaked by the Great River,”

²² There are two readings, סִיד, “chalk,” and סִיד (passive verbal form) “plastered” (see Bertinoro and Tosephot Yom-Tov on this Mishnah).

or "in a/(the) cistern of (the) spring of (the) *mikve*(s) which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Spring of Gatherings which were fed by the Great River," or "in a/(the) cistern of (the) spring of (the) *mikves* which were fed by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גּוֹיְגוּ מִיְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) middle of (the) *mikves* which is being fed/soaked by the Great River." Cf. אֵילָן בְּגוֹא, אֶרְעָא, which can be rendered in Hebrew as עֵץ בְּגוֹבְתוֹךְ הָאָרֶץ, "a tree in the midst of the earth" (BA, Dan. 4:7).

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גּוֹיְגוּ מִיְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) middle of (the) *mikves* which were fed by the Great River" — The בּוֹר in the middle of the *mikves* may also be a ritual bath. Cf. הַבּוֹר שֶׁבַחֲצֵר, "the cistern which is in the courtyard" can become a *kosher mikve* if it collects forty *se'ah* (a certain measurement of proper water (m. Miq. 3:2).

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּי מִיְקוֹה־מִיְקוֹה־מִיְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Valley of Gathering(s)/*Mikve*(s) which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּי מִיְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Valley of *Mikves* which were fed by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוֹה שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Spring of Hope/Gathering which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִיְקוֹה שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Heap of Hope/Gathering which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּי מִיְקוֹה שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Valley of Hope/Gathering which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גְּרוּגֵי <ע-מְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Spring/Depression/Valley of (the) <D>epts which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune Demonesses which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גְּרוּגְרוּגֵי מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Spring/Depression/Heap/Valley of (the) Demonesses which is being fed/-soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune Canals which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּד מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) Fortune Canals which were fed by the Great River" — In the past the canals were fed by the river.

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) spring/-depression of (the) canals which is being fed/soaked by the Great River."

הַגְּדוֹל בְּבוֹר גֵּר מִזְקוֹת שְׂרוּי־שְׂרוּי מֵהַנַּחַל הַגְּדוֹל, "in a/(the) cistern of (the) spring/-depression of (the) canals which were fed by the Great River."

ITEM 46

10:5 באשוח שיבית הכרם בבואך

10:6 לסמולו אמות עשר כסף

10:7 ככרין ששין ושנין

10:5 In the pool which is in Beth-cherem, as you come

10:6 to its left ten cubits, (there are) sixty-

10:7 two talents of silver.

COMMENTARY

(10:5) בַּאֲשִׁיחַ/בַּאֲשִׁיחַ, בַּאֲשִׁיחַ/בַּאֲשִׁיחַ, or בַּאֲשִׁיחַ/בַּאֲשִׁיחַ, “In/at/by a/the pool” — all of these possibilities have the same meaning (see #22, 5:6-7; #55, 11:12, 14). It is also possible to read as בַּאֲשִׁית = בְּשִׁית (with a *taw*), “in the deep pit,” where the *alef* may represent a Tiberian *patah*; cf. לַח for לָח, “liquid” (see #13, 3:8).

(10:5) שִׁיבִית הַכֶּרֶם = שִׁבְבִּית הַכֶּרֶם, “which is (in/at/by the) Beth-cherem (= House of Vineyard)” — The first word has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^r: שִׁיבִית for שִׁיבִית, “which is in the house of (?)”. ALLEGRO: שִׁיבִית, “which is in Beth”; the preposition *bet* is missing; שִׁי is a *plene* spelling for שִׁ, as in שִׁיבְצָפֹן (9:14), or it is like שִׁא in 1QpHab. 11:6 and in a Bar-Kochba letter from Murabba‘at. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “which is in the Place of (Beth).”¹ MILIK: שִׁיבִית, “of Beth,” has an extra *yod* in a closed syllable, as in שִׁיבְצָפֹן; שִׁיבִית could mean שִׁיבִית.² LURIE: שִׁיבִית, the *yod* is a scribal error for a *lamed*, i.e., שִׁלִּית, “of Beth.”³ WOLTERS: שִׁיבִית and שִׁיבִית, “which is in Beth.”⁴ BEYER: שִׁיבִית, “of Beth.”⁵ THORION agrees with Lurie, PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES follow Allegro, and WISE that of Milik.⁶

שִׁיבִית is a phonetic spelling for שִׁיבִית, *yod* after the relative *šin*, as in שִׁיבְצָפֹן for שִׁיבְצָפֹן, “which is in/at/by north of” (9:14; cf. Allegro, Milik). Such spellings occur in better Mishnah manuscripts; e.g., מְשִׁיבִיתָם, “since they became corrupted” (m. Ber. 9:5), שִׁיבִיתָם, “that he gathers” (m.

1 Allegro, 51, 158 n. 220, 161 n. 234; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 295-96, 228 B-4a and B-6b. Milik^E, 141.

3 Lurie, 113-14 and n. 1.

4 Wolters, 50-51 (שִׁיבִית); “Analysis,” 251 (שִׁיבִית).

5 Beyer, 230-31.

6 Thorion, 170; Pixner, 354; Garcia Martinez, 463; Vermes, 377; Wise, 196.

Ma'as. 1:5) in the Kaufmann manuscript.⁷

One would expect שְׁבִיבִית rather than שִׁבִּיבִית = שְׁבִיבִית;⁸ cf. אֲשֶׁר בְּבֵית הַבּוֹר (= שְׁבִיבִית הַבּוֹר), "which is in the dungeon" (Exod. 12:29); לְאֲשֶׁר בְּבֵית שֶׁאֵן, "for (those) which are in Beth-shean and her daughters (i.e., its villages) and for (those) which are in the Valley of Jezreel" (Josh. 17:16). However, frequently the prepositions בְּ-, לְ-, and אֶל in front of בֵּית (const.) are absent, but implied. E.g., (= בְּבֵית), וְהַמֶּלֶךְ יוֹשֵׁב בֵּית, "and the king was dwelling in the winter house" (Jer. 36:22). Thus, בֵּית may connote, "in/to (the) house of."⁹ Moreover, when the first element of a compound toponym is בֵּית, "house of," it could mean "city/family of" (see #7, 2:3).

וְעַל בֵּית הַכֶּרֶם שָׂאוּ מִשְׁאָתָּה appears twice in the Masoretic Text: "and upon Beth-cherem set up a signal" (Jer. 6:1); and מַלְכִּיָּה בֶן רֵכָב שַׂר פָּלָךְ, "Malchija ben Rechab, the ruler of the district of Beth-cherem" (Neh. 3:14). The Targum of בֵּית הַכֶּרֶם is בְּקֶעֶת בֵּית כְּרָמָא, "Valley of the House of the Vineyards" (Jer. 6:1); cf. בְּקֶעֶת בֵּית כְּרָם, "Valley of Beth-cherem" (m. Mid. 3:4; m. Nid. 2:7; t. Nid. 3:11). Similarly, וְאַבְרָם שָׂרָא, "and Abram dwelt in the Valley of Shaveh that is the King's Valley, the Valley of Beth-cherem" (1QapGen 22:13-14; see also #1, 1:1; #36, 8:10).¹⁰

7 Likewise, *yod* occurs after the prefixed בְּ-, לְ-, מְ-, and שֶׁל-. E.g., בִּיצֵר (m. 'Ed. 2:8), לִי־סִיכָה (m. Shab. 9:3), מִישׁוּלֵי (m. Kel. 27:4; ed. Low), שְׁלִיחַ בּוֹרִים (m. B.Q. 10:2). See MNM 2, 1243-44; M. Bar-Asher, "צורות נדירות בלשון התנאים," in *Lešonenu* 41 (1976/77), 83-88. Regarding שִׁיילִקוּט, the spelling may reflect a vocalization of שִׁיילִקוּט, the second *yod* is for the short *hiriq* under the *yod*.

8 It is rather difficult to pronounce three *bets* in sequence in the word שְׁבִיבִית (= שְׁבִיבִית), but not so with שִׁבִּיבִית (= שְׁבִיבִית). This is like the explanation offered by Ibn-Ezra and 'Avi-'Ezer regarding the word וְהִלְלוּ, "and they praised" (Gen. 12:15), which should have been vocalized as וְהִלְלוּ (= וְהִלְלוּ), but since it is difficult to pronounce three *lameds* in a series, the first *lamed* has no *dageš forte*.

9 Cf. Rashi says that בֵּית אֵל means בְּבֵית אֵל, "in Beth-el," and presents other such cases (Gen. 35:6). Segal lists ten cases in the Masoretic Text where the *bet* is missing (*Genuzot Rashi* [1979], 20). Ibn-Ezra notes that בֵּית אָבִיךָ means בְּבֵית אָבִיךָ, "in your father's house" (Gen. 38:11). In many of these cases the Targumim do not add the missing *bet*. According to BDB (108b), when a modifying word follows בֵּית, it means "in the house of." Steinberg says that the root of בֵּית is בִּי, בְּ-, "inside, to approach"; in the Masoretic Text the construct בֵּית in 67 cases means בְּבֵית and 60 cases בֵּית אֵל. It should be added that the mix usage of בְּ-, לְ-, and אֶל in the Masoretic Text, as well in the Targum, can be seen in verses Jer. 37:4, 15-16, 18, 20. The opposite also occurs; in two cases the *ketiv* has an extra *bet*; בְּבֵית ה' (*ketiv*, "in the House of the Lord") vs. בֵּית ה' (*qeri*, "House of Lord," 2 Kgs 22:5); and בְּבֵית הַפְּקָרֶת (*ketiv*, "in the jail") vs. בֵּית הַפְּקָרֶת (*qeri*, "the jail," Jer. 52:11). Interestingly, in both cases the Targumim follow the *ketiv*, בְּבֵית מְקוֹשָׁא רַה' ("in the Holy House of the Lord"); and בְּבֵית אֲסִירֵי ("in the jail," respectively). Perhaps, during a certain period it was a tendency to use בֵּית instead of בְּבֵית.

10 Many of these sources are mentioned by the scholars. עֲמָק, "valley" (from the root עֲמַק, "be deep") and בְּקֶעֶת, "valley" (from the root בָּקַע, "to cleave, break open") are

Aharoni discusses the various references to Beth-cherem in the Talmud, Genesis Apocryphon, and Copper Scroll. He points out that the Scroll mentions גרם (10:3) in the region of the unidentified הנחל הגדול (Great Nahal, or "big valley," that may be the Kidron Valley, 10:3-4), then Beth-cherem (10:5), יד אבשלום (Pillar of Absalom, 10:12), and בריכת השילוח (the Pool of Siloah, 10:17). Aharoni concludes that this list places Beth-cherem in the vicinity of Jerusalem. He identifies Beth-Cherem with Ramat-Rahel, and adds that Milik accedes to this.¹¹

(10:6-7) בְּבֹאֲךָ לְסִמּוּלוֹ אֶמּוֹת עֶסֶר, "as you come/go to its (masc.) left/north" — בְּבֹאֲךָ and לְסִמּוּלוֹ have basically the same meaning (for a detailed discussion, see #16, 4:3). לְסִמּוּלוֹ is a phonetic spelling for לְשִׁמְאָלוֹ, "to its (masc.) left/north" (see #5, 1:13); it refers to the masculine אֲשִׁיחַ, "pool," rather than to Beth-cherem. Regarding phonetic spellings, see #21, 5:1; #35, 8:8; for directions, #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #19, 4:11.

The text has גמות עסר instead of אַמּוֹת עֶסֶר, "ten cubits," and so later גמות עסרה for אַמּוֹת שְׁתֵּי עֶסְרָה, "twelve cubits," i.e., *gimmel* for 'alef (see #48, 10:13; also #38, 9:2); both are scribal errors.

The phrase "as you come/go toward" suggests that "ten cubits" refers to distance, i.e., "as you come/go toward the left of the pool at a distance of ten cubits..." However, it could also be depth, i.e., "as you come/go to the pool's left side, ten cubits deep"

Finally, one can read בְּבֹאֲךָ לְסִמּוּלוֹ גְּמּוֹת עֶסֶר, "as you come/go to(ward) its (masc.) left, (there are) ten (small) pits" (cf. Wolters). For a detailed discussion, see #48, 10:13.

(10:7) כֶּסֶף כְּכֶרֶן שִׁשִּׁין וּשְׁנַיִן, "(there are) sixty-two talents of silver" — The text has כְּרֶרֶן, an obvious scribal error. The unusual lettering of this word is recognized by ALLEGRO and MILIK.¹² This error uncovers very important in-

synonyms. According to Klein, two cities were named Beth-cherem, one in Judea and the other in Galille (*SY* [1939] 1, 15 and nn. a-b). See also, S. Ahitov, "עֵמֶק הַמֶּלֶךְ" in *EB* 6, 296.

11 Y. Aharoni, "Excavations at Ramat Rahel," *BA* 24 (1961) 114-117; "General Conclusions," *Excavations at Ramat Rahel, Seasons 1959 and 1960* (1962), 49-51, 60; "General Conclusions," *Excavations at Ramat Rahel, Seasons 1961 and 1962* (1964), 122-24; "Beth Haccherem," *Archaeology and Old Testament Study* (1967), 182-83; "Bet(h)-Cherem," *EJ* 4, 716-19; S. Yeivin, "בית הכרם" in *EB* 2, 84-85. The following should be added: (1) Aharoni relies on Milik's original version published prior to his official edition. (2) Milik retracted his original suggestion of גרם. (3) The reading בריכת השילוח is only an educated guess on Milik's part. (4) Aharoni fails to mention the problematic בימי של גי איך (10:8) which may also be in the same area.

12 Allegro, 161, n. 238; Milik, 295.

ternal evidence. The first scribe originally wrote a single *kaf*, and later, perhaps a second one, added the letters ררין. Not only are the two *rešes* much smaller than the average letter of this line, but they also are somewhat rounded, rather than having corners like the other characters of this line. In addition, there is a *lamed* in the next line below the second *reš*. The upper vertical arm of this *lamed* projects up into the line above. One has the impression that the scribe deliberately sought to avoid that the second *reš* should touch the upper vertical arm of the *lamed*. This indicates that the correction took place after the *lamed* of the next line had been engraved. Apparently, the scribe was not an expert engraver, since the correction itself contains an error, כררין instead of ככרין.

While in at least seven cases in the Scroll ככרין, "talents," can be read as ככרין, "in pitchers," here it cannot be read in this manner. Nevertheless, BEYER reads it here as בכרין.¹³ For similar corrections elsewhere in the Scroll, and the possible readings of בכרין, see Appendix A.

13 Beyer, 230-31.

ITEM 47

10:8 בימ של גיא וך בצדו המערבי
 10:9 אבן שחוריא אמות שתין
 10:10 הו הפתח ככרין שלש מאות
 10:11 זהב וכלין כופרין עסרה

10:8 In the Pool of the Pure Valley, at its western side
 10:9 (there is) a black stone, (at a distance of) two cubits
 10:10 is the entrance, (there are) three hundred talents of
 10:11 gold, plus ten bowl vessels.

COMMENTARY

(10:8) בַּיַּמִּם שֶׁל גֵּיא וְךָ, "In/at/by (the) Pool of Pure Valley" — ALLEGRO¹: "In the cistern of the Treasury" (i.e., בִּימָם שֶׁל גִּוּיָךְ; as in BH גִּוּיָךְ, "treasury" (1 Chron. 28:11) (?). ALLEGRO: בִּימָם שֶׁל גֵּיא זֵית, "In the vat of the olive press (?)." ים means "tank" of meal, wine, oil press (MH); גֵּיא is a variant of גַּת; זֵית for זֵית (the *dalet*, elongated to final *kaf*, for a *taw*). ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the basin of the Valley of [...]." ¹ MILIK: בִּימָם שֶׁל גֵּיא, "In the pool of the vale of ..."; גֵּיא איב is for גֵּיא איב (= גֵּיא איב), Valley of Job, which may be Bir Ayyub or Wadi (Bir) Ayyub. ² CROSS: גִּיחֹן, Milik's original reading, is better than גֵּיא איב. ³ LURIE: בִּימָם שֶׁל גֵּיא זֵית, "In the pool which is located (in Beth-cherem) ... (to hide there) bundles." ⁴ PIXNER: בִּימָם שֶׁל גֵּיא זֵית, "In the large basin of the Valley of Zokh (?); גֵּיא זֵית, "valley of purity, limpidity," should be between Beth-Hakerem and Yad Abshalom, and may be identified with Wadi Yassul. ⁵ WOLTERS: בִּימָם שֶׁל גֵּיא זֵית, "In the pool of the Zered George." ⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "In the water tank of the valley of Zok (?)." ⁷ BEYER (reads as Milik): "At the reserve basin of the valley of

1 Allegro, 51, 161-62 nn. 239-40; Allegro^{rev}, 25.

2 Milik, 219; 266-67 D-26; 295-96; 390-91 "Addenda" to D-26; Milik^E, 141.

3 F.M. Cross Jr., "Excursus on the Palaeographical Dating of the Copper Document," *DJD* III, 219 (גִּיאִיךְ is a typographical error for גֵּיאִיךְ). גִּיחֹן, Gihon, is: (1) a spring southeast of Jerusalem (e.g., 2 Chron. 32:30); (2) one of the four rivers of the Garden of Eden (Gen. 2:13; see Rashi on b. Ber. 10b, *Tosephot Yom-Tov* on m. Pes. 4:9).

4 Lurie, 114-15 and nn. 1-3.

5 Pixner, 354 and n. 41 ("Gy Zokh" is a typographical error for "Gey Zokh").

6 Wolters, 50-51.

7 Garcia Martinez, 463.

